

A photograph of three IFRC staff members in a refugee camp. On the left, a man in a dark polo shirt and cap is gesturing while speaking. In the center, a woman in a red IFRC vest and sunglasses is listening. On the right, another man in a red IFRC vest and cap is also listening. They are standing in front of several blue and green tents in a dusty, arid environment with hills in the background.

EMERGENCY NEEDS ASSESSMENT AND PLANNING

Guidance

2025



The International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC) is the world's largest humanitarian network, with 191 National Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies and around 15 million volunteers. Our volunteers are present in communities before, during and after a crisis or disaster. We work in the most hard to reach and complex settings in the world, saving lives and promoting human dignity. We support communities to become stronger and more resilient places where people can live safe and healthy lives and have opportunities to thrive.

THE FUNDAMENTAL PRINCIPLES OF THE INTERNATIONAL RED CROSS AND RED CRESCENT MOVEMENT

Humanity

The International Red Cross and Red Crescent Movement, born of a desire to bring assistance without discrimination to the wounded on the battlefield, endeavours, in its international and national capacity, to prevent and alleviate human suffering wherever it may be found. Its purpose is to protect life and health and to ensure respect for the human being. It promotes mutual understanding, friendship, cooperation and lasting peace amongst all peoples.

Impartiality

It makes no discrimination as to nationality, race, religious beliefs, class or political opinions. It endeavours to relieve the suffering of individuals, being guided solely by their needs, and to give priority to the most urgent cases of distress.

Neutrality

In order to enjoy the confidence of all, the Movement may not take sides in hostilities or engage at any time in controversies of a political, racial, religious or ideological nature.

Independence

The Movement is independent. The National Societies, while auxiliaries in the humanitarian services of their governments and subject to the laws of their respective countries, must always maintain their autonomy so that they may be able at all times to act in accordance with the principles of the Movement.

Voluntary service

It is a voluntary relief movement not prompted in any manner by desire for gain.

Unity

There can be only one Red Cross or Red Crescent Society in any one country. It must be open to all. It must carry on its humanitarian work throughout its territory.

Universality

The International Red Cross and Red Crescent Movement, in which all societies have equal status and share equal responsibilities and duties in helping each other, is worldwide.

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FOREWORD

The International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC) is committed to ensuring that its humanitarian response efforts are grounded in a comprehensive understanding of the needs, vulnerabilities, and capacities of affected populations. This Emergency Needs Assessment (ENA) guidance document serves as a crucial tool in fulfilling that commitment.

This guide offers a practical and adaptable framework for conducting ENAs in diverse crisis contexts, empowering humanitarian practitioners to gather timely and relevant information that informs effective decision-making and impactful response strategies. By synthesising best practices and incorporating valuable insights from across the IFRC network, this guidance represents a collective effort to strengthen our capacity to respond to disasters and crises in a way that upholds the dignity and rights of those affected.

We express our sincere gratitude to the dedicated individuals and organisations who contributed their expertise to the development of this guidance. Their commitment to enhancing humanitarian practice is truly inspiring.

We encourage all Red Cross and Red Crescent staff, volunteers, and partners to utilise this guidance and contribute to the continuous improvement of ENA methodologies. Together, we can ensure that our response efforts are informed, coordinated, and impactful, ultimately making a meaningful difference in the lives of those we serve.



Caroline Holt

Director, Disasters, Climate and Crises Department
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ACRONYMS

• AC	Assessment Cell	• JTF	Joint Task Force
• ACAPS	Assessment Capacities Project	• KII	Key Informant Interview
• ATWG	Assessment Technical Working Group	• LAT	Livelihoods Assessment Tool-Kit
• BRT	Branch Response Teams	• MDC	Mobile Data Collection
• CEA	Community Engagement and Accountability	• MIRA	Multi-Cluster Initial Rapid Assessment
• CODs	Common Operational Datasets	• NFIs	Non-Food Items
• DM	Disaster Management	• NGO	Non-Governmental Organisation
• DREF	Disaster Response Emergency Fund	• NRT	National Response Teams
• DRR	Disaster Risk Reduction	• NS	National Society
• EA	Emergency Appeal	• ODK	Open Data Kit
• EIA	Environmental Impact Assessment	• OS	Operational Strategy
• ENA	Emergency Needs Assessment	• PER	Preparedness for Effective Response
• ERU	Emergency Response Unit	• PGI	Protection, Gender, and Inclusion
• FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations	• PMER	Planning, Monitoring, Evaluation, and Reporting
• FGD	Focus Group Discussion	• PMR	Periodic Monitoring Report
• FewsNET	Famine Early Warning Systems Network	• POA	Plan of Action
• GIS	Geographic Information System	• PDM	Post Distribution Monitoring
• GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation	• PNS	Partner National Society
• HEOps	Head of Emergency Operations	• RAM	Rapid Assessment of Markets
• HNO	Humanitarian Needs Overview	• RAT	Rapid Assessment Toolkit
• HR	Human Resources	• RCRC	Red Cross Red Crescent
• HRP	Humanitarian Response Plan	• RRT	Regional Response Team
• IASC	Inter-Agency Standing Committee	• SGBV	Sexual and Gender-Based Violence
• ICRC	International Committee of the Red Cross	• SIMS	Surge Information Management Support
• IFRC	International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies	• SOFA	Situation, Observation, Feelings, Advice/Acknowledgment
• IAT	Initial Assessment Tool	• SOPs	Standard Operating Procedures
• ILO	International Labour Organization	• SPM	Sectoral Parameter Mapping
• IM	Information Management	• SPMA	Sectoral Parameter Mapping Assessment
• IMWG	Information Management Working Group	• SWOT	Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats
• INGO	International Non-Governmental Organisation	• TKIA	Technical Key Informant Assessment
• IP	Implementation plan	• ToR	Terms of Reference
• IPC	Integrated Food Security Phase Classification	• UN	United Nations
• IQR	Interquartile Range	• USG	Under Secretary General
		• VCA	Vulnerability and Capacity Assessment
		• WASH	Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene
		• 3W	Who, What, Where

KEY TERMINOLOGY & DEFINITIONS

- **Analytical Framework:** A structured approach used in ENA to guide the collection and analysis of data, ensuring a comprehensive understanding of the crisis and its impacts. It comprises four key objectives and associated indicators that facilitate the assessment process.
 - **Crisis Impacts:** A thorough assessment of the direct and indirect consequences of the crisis on individuals, communities, and systems, encompassing the identification and quantification of the types and extent of damage, loss, and disruption.
 - **Crisis Profile:**
 - A comprehensive analysis of the historical, political, social, and economic factors that have shaped the current crisis. This encompasses understanding the hazards, vulnerabilities, capacities, and coping mechanisms of the affected population within the broader context.
 - A comprehensive understanding of the broader context of a crisis, including its historical, political, social, and economic dimensions.
 - **Gaps in the Response:** A systematic examination of ongoing response efforts to pinpoint any unmet needs, deficiencies in service provision, and areas requiring additional support. This includes evaluating the capacity and coordination of humanitarian actors and identifying any potential duplication of efforts.
 - **Severity of Conditions:** A critical evaluation of the gravity and urgency of the crisis impacts, involving the measurement of the magnitude and intensity of the damage, loss, and disruption, and the identification of the most vulnerable groups and areas.
- **Assessment Cell (AC):** A specialised team deployed in-country or remotely to support National Societies in conducting Emergency Needs Assessments and other humanitarian needs analyses.
- **Assessment Strategy:** An overarching plan guiding all ENA activities, defining aims, objectives, scope, scale, timeframes, resources, key activities, expected deliverables, and coordination mechanisms.
- **Assessment Workflow:** A structured, five-step process for designing and implementing ENAs: (1) Contextualize, (2) Design, (3) Collect, (4) Analyse, and (5) Share.
- **Common Operational Datasets (CODs):** Standardised datasets used across different organisations and sectors to ensure data comparability and avoid duplication of efforts..
- **Data Preparedness:** The process of collecting and collating relevant data before a crisis occurs to facilitate rapid and effective needs assessments.
- **Emergency Needs Assessment (ENA):** A systematic process for gathering, analysing, and interpreting data on the needs, context, and preferences of people affected by disasters and crises.
- **Focus Group Discussion (FGD):** A qualitative data collection method involving a group discussion led by a moderator to explore perceptions, opinions, and experiences on a particular topic.
- **Information Gaps:** Missing or incomplete information that needs to be addressed through further assessment.
- **Initial Assessment Tool (IAT):** A tool used to establish sectoral priorities and key operational insights, such as market functionality and access constraints.
- **Key Informant Interviews (KIIs):** Interviews conducted with individuals who possess specialised knowledge or insights relevant to the assessment.

- **Needs Monitoring (Continual Assessment):** Regular updates on the situation and beneficiary feedback collected after a detailed assessment to inform long-term decision-making.
- **Operational Strategy (OS):** A detailed plan outlining the strategic priorities, long-term programme impacts, and response options for an emergency operation.
- **Primary Data:** Data collected directly from affected populations or other primary sources through methods like surveys, interviews, and focus group discussions.
- **Response Options Analysis:** A systematic process for evaluating and selecting the most appropriate interventions to address identified needs.
- **Secondary Data:** Data collected from existing sources, such as reports, databases, and previous assessments.
- **Sectoral Parameter Mapping Assessment (SPMA):** An assessment using the SPM framework to understand the overall sectoral picture within affected districts, determine priority areas, and prioritise sectoral needs.
- **Severity Ranking:** A method for identifying and prioritising the most critical issues and needs based on their severity and impact.
- **Surge Capacity:** The ability to rapidly deploy additional resources and expertise to support emergency response efforts.
- **Technical Key Informant Assessment (TKIA):** An assessment designed to capture technical insights into specific sectors to complement broader quantitative sectoral assessment data with qualitative insights.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

We extend our sincere gratitude to the countless individuals and organisations whose dedication and expertise have shaped this Emergency Needs Assessment (ENA) guidance document.

We particularly acknowledge the invaluable contributions of the core members of the Assessment Technical Working Group (ATWG) - Francisco Maldonado, Marshal Mukuvare, Luke Caley, Eero Sario, Onurcan Ceyhan, and Vincent Annoni - who expertly steered this project's direction.

A special thanks goes to all contributors from the Assessment Technical Working Group (ATWG), with particular recognition for the technical support provided by members of the British, French, Italian, and American Red Cross. Their insights and feedback were crucial throughout the development process. We also thank all the National Societies that participated in the global consultation, which played a vital role in guiding this project.

We gratefully acknowledge the financial support provided by both the British and French Red Cross, which made this project possible.

Finally, we thank Marjorie Sotofranco, Sumiko May, Miguel Aguirre, and Santiago Luengo for their tireless efforts in finalising and publishing the content, ensuring its accessibility to the humanitarian community today.

This document reflects the collective commitment of the humanitarian community to strengthen our capacity to respond effectively to disasters and crises, ensuring that the needs of affected populations are addressed with timely and impactful assistance.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This Emergency Needs Assessment (ENA) technical guidance equips Red Cross Red Crescent (RCRC) staff, volunteers, and practitioners with best practices for conducting effective needs assessments in disaster and crisis situations. It covers the entire assessment process, from understanding the context to sharing findings and evaluating the process.

The guidance emphasises a flexible and adaptable approach, recognizing that ENA methodologies must be tailored to the specific operational needs and context of each emergency. It provides a structured framework, the "Assessment Workflow," to guide the process, encompassing five key stages: Contextualize, Design, Collect, Analyze, and Share. Each stage is explored in detail, highlighting key activities, outputs, and relevant tools and resources.

The guidance also outlines various types of ENAs, including initial, rapid, and in-depth assessments, along with additional assessment considerations like Rapid Assessment of Markets (RAM) and Vulnerability and Capacity Assessments (VCA). It emphasises the importance of data preparedness, ethical and safe data collection practices, and effective data management and analysis.

Furthermore, the guidance stresses the significance of the human element in ENA. It outlines roles and responsibilities within assessment teams, particularly within the context of IFRC operations, and highlights the importance of collaboration, capacity building, and knowledge sharing.

By following this guidance, humanitarian practitioners can ensure that their needs assessments are conducted systematically, ethically, and with a focus on generating actionable insights that inform effective decision-making and impactful humanitarian response.



Chapter 1: Understanding ENAs

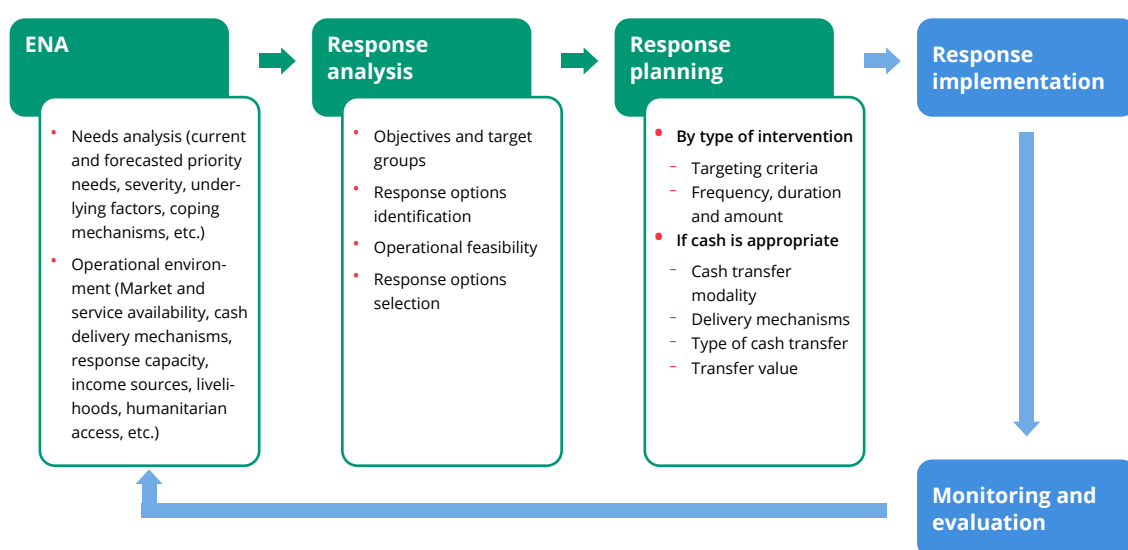
Chapter 1: Understanding ENAs

The reader understands what Emergency Needs Assessments (ENA) entail and why they are crucial before planning a response.

1.1. Who this guidance is for

This Emergency Needs Assessment (ENA) technical guidance is intended for all Red Cross Red Crescent (RCRC) staff, volunteers, and technical practitioners involved in conducting emergency needs assessments. It is also relevant for IFRC delegates who may provide support during large-scale emergencies necessitating international assistance. The guidance consolidates existing best practices from across the IFRC network.

Figure 1: The Emergency Response Cycle



Emergency needs assessments systematically identify, gather, analyse, and disseminate insights into the needs, context, and preferences of individuals affected by disasters and crises. In essence, ENAs inform operational strategies and response planning for emergency operations. While ENA results have a broader audience, this guidance focuses on providing best practices and links to templates, tools, and practical examples. Therefore, users should ideally possess some information management skills and experience or technical expertise in project cycle areas such as needs assessment, information management, planning, implementation, reporting, and evaluation. However, the guidelines can also serve as a valuable resource for anyone seeking to understand ENAs and their associated processes.

Scope of the ENA guidance

Within scope:

- Outlines the types of assessments associated with ENAs and their appropriate applications.
- Describes an ideal process (assessment workflow) for conducting an ENA, including key steps, activities, and expected outputs.
- Provides tools, templates, checklists, and other resources to support each step of the assessment workflow.
- Outlines the roles, team structures, and resources necessary for effective ENA implementation.

Out of scope:

- In-depth methodologies for detailed or sectoral assessments.
- Specifics of ongoing response monitoring.

1.2. How to use these guidelines

These guidelines offer practical advice on conducting an Emergency Needs Assessment (ENA) from the initial stages of a disaster or crisis until a detailed response plan is formulated. National Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies, often the first to respond to disasters and crises across diverse contexts, are present before, during, and after such events.

While the guidelines may not encompass every possible scenario requiring an ENA, they provide a versatile framework for planning and executing assessments. By following them, you can systematically address the key activities necessary for a successful ENA. The relevance of specific sections may vary depending on the nature of the situation you encounter. The suggestions provided here can be adapted to suit any context. Curiosity and rigour are essential qualities for conducting effective assessments. These guidelines aim to empower RCRC personnel to apply these qualities effectively in emergency situations.

This guidance is organised into five chapters, each functioning independently while complementing the others. This allows users with varying levels of knowledge and experience to access the most relevant content directly. Chapter 5 deviates from the narrative structure, serving as a toolbox of resources that collectively form the ENA Toolkit. These resources are referenced throughout the chapters, and the toolbox can also be utilised as a standalone resource.

Chapter Summaries

- 1. Chapter 1:** Understanding ENAs - Provides an overview of ENAs, encompassing their methodology, workflow, and analytical approach to generating actionable insights.
- 2. Chapter 2:** The Different Types of ENAs - Explores the various types of ENAs, their ideal use cases, strengths, weaknesses, resource requirements, timeframes, and the types of data they produce and utilise.
- 3. Chapter 3:** The ENA Process - Details the recommended steps for conducting an ENA, known as the Assessment Workflow. The assessment workflow offers a logical and straightforward method to guide actions, ensure systematic issue resolution, and generate actionable outputs at each stage.
- 4. Chapter 4:** IFRC and ENA - Highlights the roles and responsibilities of individuals involved in an ENA, along with recommendations for team composition. It also outlines how ENA informs operational decision-making.
- 5. Chapter 5:** ENA Toolkit - This chapter provides a comprehensive collection of resources to support the implementation of the ENA workflow, including templates, mini-guides, illustrative examples, and practical tools.

1.3. What is the ENA approach?

These guidelines offer practical advice on conducting an Emergency Needs Assessment (ENA) from the initial stages of a disaster or crisis until a detailed response plan is formulated. National Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies, often the first to respond to disasters and crises across diverse contexts, are present before, during, and after such events.

Aim

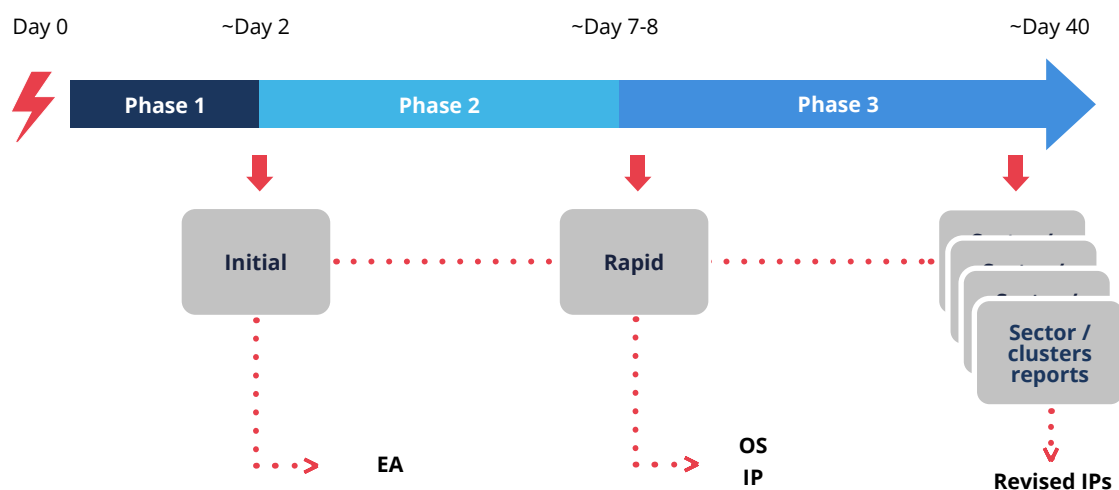
The primary aim of an assessment is to gain a comprehensive understanding of a situation. This involves identifying the existing problems, their root causes, and the consequences they have. It's important to remember that an assessment's purpose is not to pinpoint a specific intervention, but rather to determine whether any intervention is necessary at all.

Approach

The Fundamental Principles of the International Red Cross and Red Crescent Movement serve as the bedrock for all activities undertaken by National Societies and the secretariat. These principles form an essential foundation for conducting assessments. In addition to these core principles, several practical considerations should also guide the assessment process:

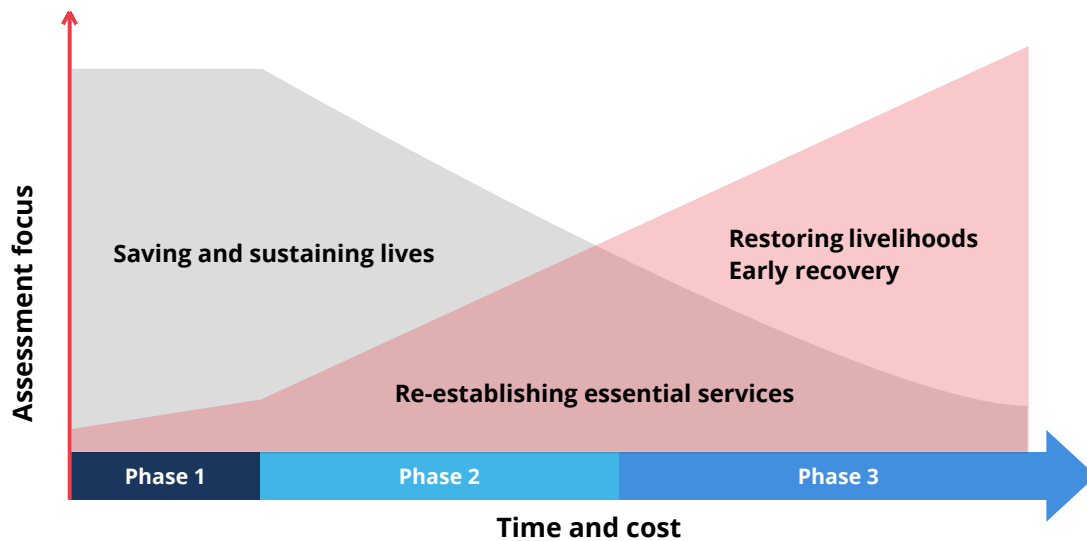
- **Align Timeframes with Response Planning:** Establish a well-defined assessment strategy for ENA that allows for adapting assessment timeframes to response planning requirements (e.g., DREF requests, Emergency Appeals, etc.).

Figure 2: Adapting timeframes to response planning



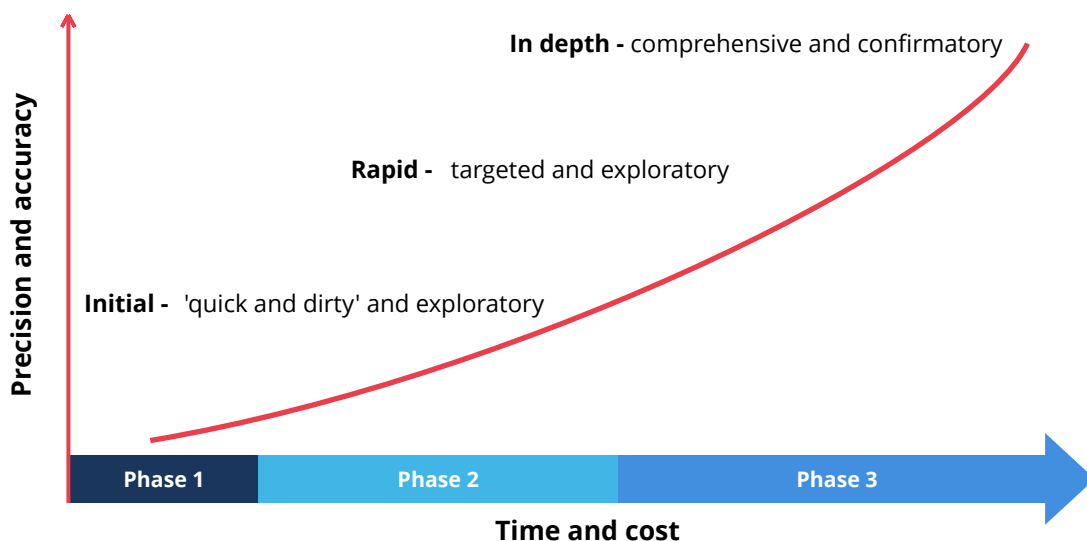
- **Clearly Define Objectives:** For each assessment, articulate clear objectives and identify the anticipated outputs and decisions it will support. This may include determining the need for a response, the necessity of international surge capacity, defining priority interventions and geographical areas, or identifying targeted population groups.
- **Recognize the Shifting Focus:** The initial focus may be on saving and sustaining lives. However, this can rapidly evolve into understanding livelihood disruptions and identifying early recovery needs. This multifaceted focus is essential to inform various, often overlapping, phases of emergency programming. Prioritisation is key, as it may not always be feasible to address all emergency response focuses equally.

Figure 3: Focus changes overtime



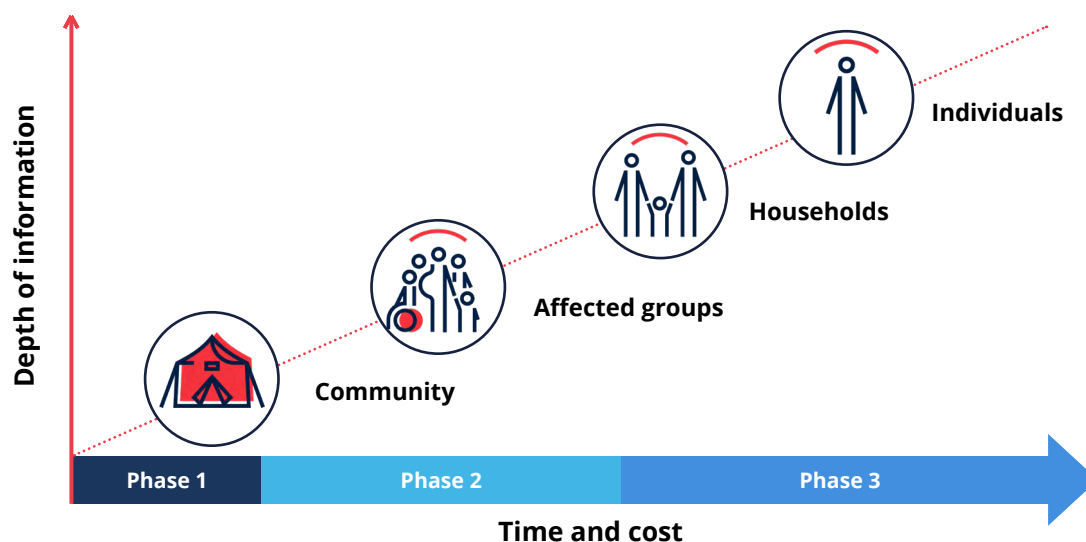
- **Embrace Increasing Precision and Accuracy:** The initial assessment may be rapid, less structured, and exploratory in nature. As the operation progresses, assessments become more targeted, with deliberate site selection. The goal is to gather information about the crisis's impact and understand why certain areas or groups are more severely affected. Later in the operation, assessments become more comprehensive and confirmatory, employing representative techniques to obtain precise data and validate earlier hypotheses.

Figure 4: Assessment precision and accuracy increase over time



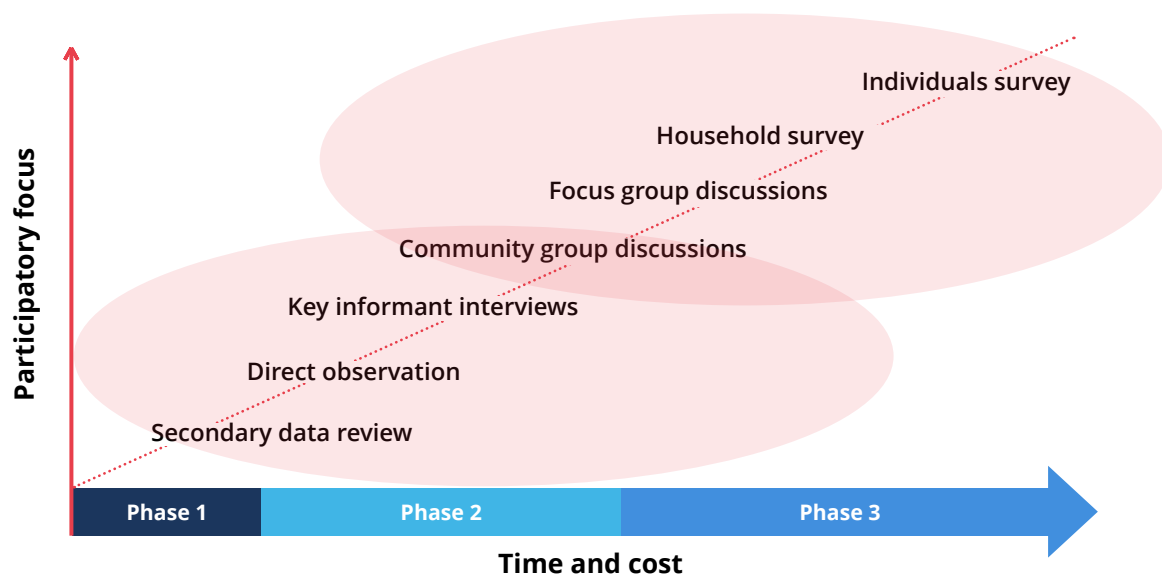
- **Provide Increasing Detail:** Time constraints in each phase limit the amount of data that can be collected. It is crucial to be clear about the information required to achieve the assessment's objectives versus information that will not be utilised.

Figure 5: Assessment provides more detail over time



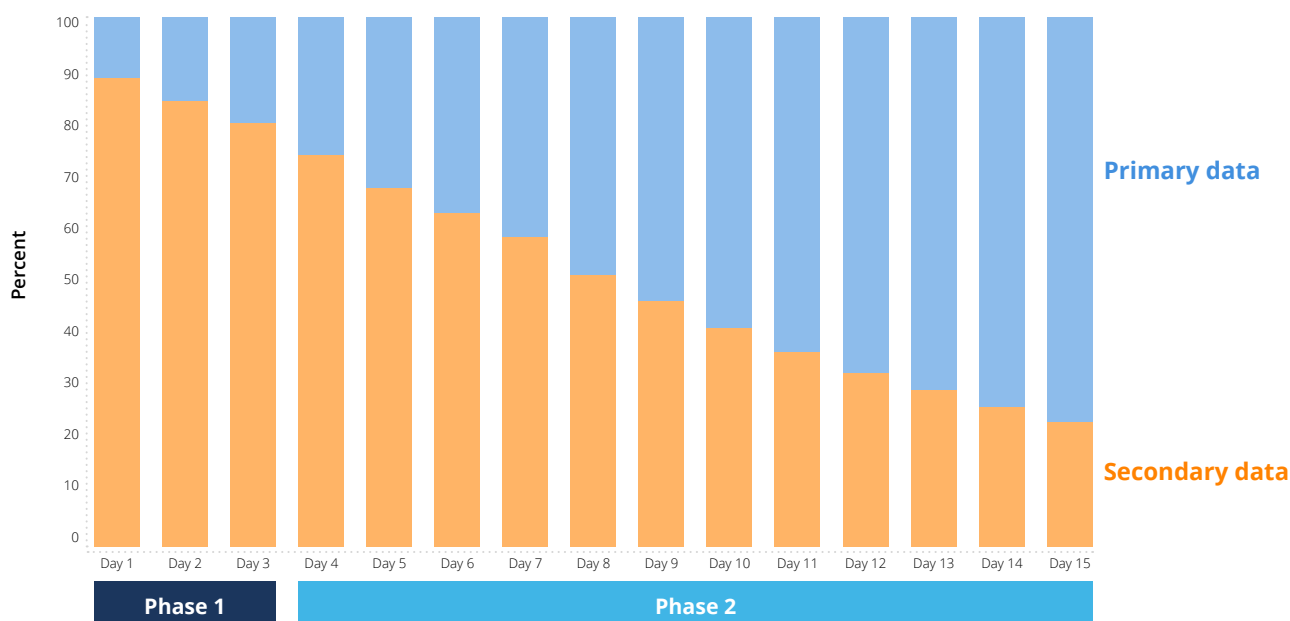
- **Foster Participatory Data Collection:** Assessments should become increasingly participatory over time. The continuous nature of assessments underscores the ongoing process, making it vital to inform the design of subsequent assessments based on previous work.

Figure 6: Data collection techniques are increasingly participatory over time



- **Utilise Secondary Data:** Secondary data can be a critical component of any ENA process. The reliance on secondary data may vary depending on the context, but in most situations, it will be heavily utilised initially and decrease as the operation progresses.
- **Disaggregate data by sex, age, and disability:** The level of data disaggregation should also increase over time, to support an effective operation that can address concerns of protection, gender and inclusion. See guidance here: pgi.ifrc.org/disability-data

Figure 7: Shift from secondary to primary data use in the first two weeks



Coordination

The coordination of assessments can take various forms (Figure 8 provides an overview of these approaches). National Societies, as auxiliaries to public authorities, are often called upon to participate in joint assessments and may also be invited to collaborate with external partners. However, it is crucial to weigh the pros and cons before engaging in coordinated or joint assessments. Refer to Table 1 for a list of positive and negative aspects of coordinated assessments.

Figure 8: Overview of Assessment Coordination Approaches

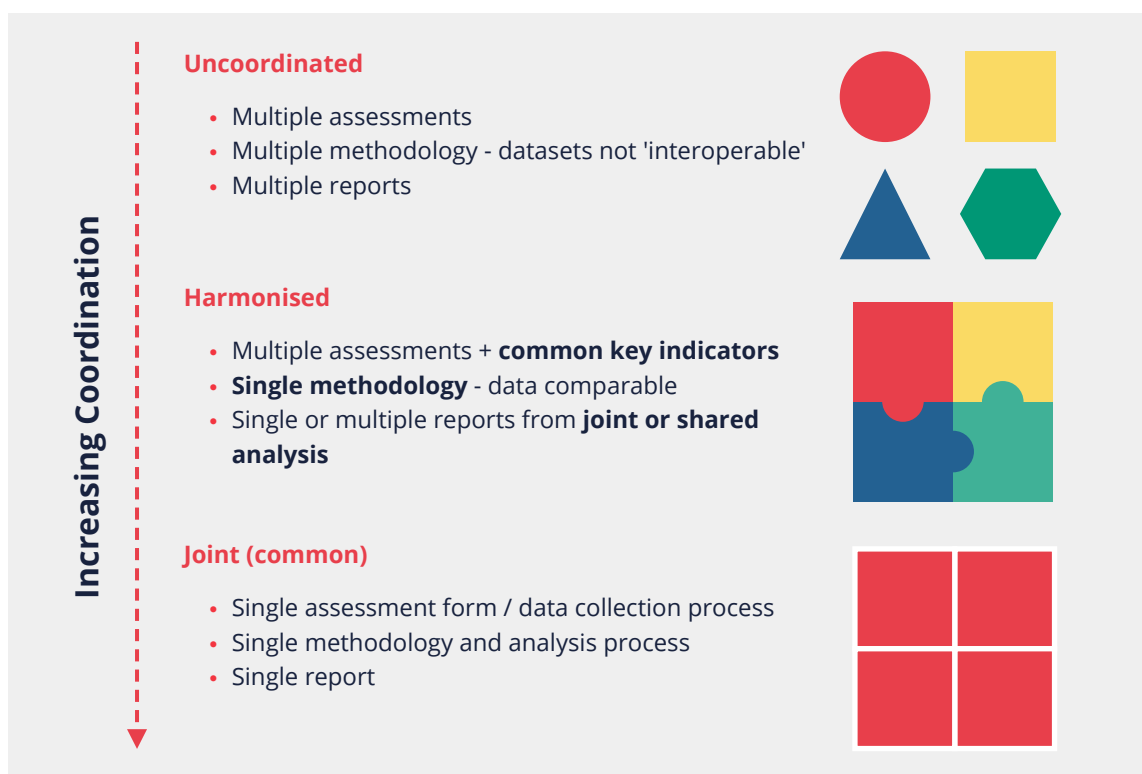


Table 1: Positive and negative aspects of coordinated assessments

Positive	Negative
• Improve coordination and cooperation for the planning and implementation of projects • More efficient use of resources, logistics, staff, etc. • Reduce the potential for assessment fatigue among the affected population • Increase coverage of assessments	• Potential increased security threat by collaborating with partners in some contexts • Collaboration may jeopardise the principles of impartiality or neutrality • Partners may have specific bias or be mandate driven • May take longer to organise and agree upon a methodology

It is important to consider whether it is appropriate to undertake joint assessments with potential external partners. Box 1 below provides a series of questions aimed at ascertaining the relevance/appropriateness of undertaking a joint assessment.

Box 1: Key Considerations for Joint Assessments

- Are organisational values and operating principles compatible?
- Could collaboration jeopardise fundamental principles, particularly neutrality and impartiality?
- Are organisations and/or individuals perceived as being biased?
- Does the organisation possess specific skills, experience, or resources (human and material) that would benefit the assessment?
- Will partnering enhance the efficiency of the assessment?
- Will partnering result in broader geographical or affected population coverage?

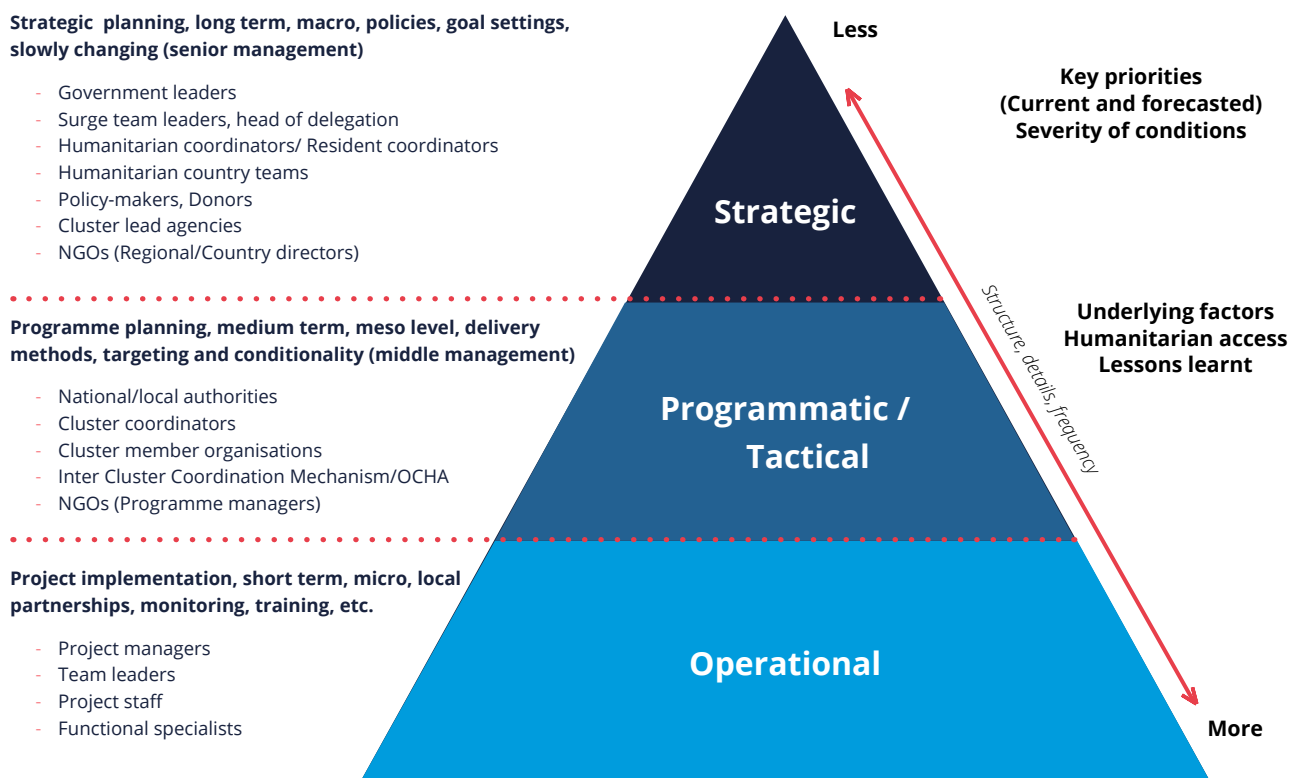
Regardless of whether an assessment is conducted independently or in coordination with others, it is essential for National Societies and the Secretariat to be aware of other ongoing assessments. This awareness helps prevent duplication of efforts and may enable broader coverage of the affected area. Understanding the diverse roles that Movement components and other actors play in assessments is also crucial.

1.4. How ENA Supports Decision-Making?

Assessment is a core component of the programme management cycle, providing a comprehensive understanding of a situation to identify problems, their origins, and their consequences. This assessment information is crucial for effectively organising a project or programme's activities. An ENA should not be viewed as an isolated process, but rather as an integral programme management tool for decision-making in emergency operations.

In an emergency context, ENA serves as a core competency for initial operational planning. It aims to provide insights into four key areas: (1) Crisis profile, (2) Crisis impacts, (3) Severity of conditions, and (4) Gaps in the response. When combined, these areas contribute to an analytical conclusion that identifies current and forecasted priority needs, affected groups, and geographical areas. Decision-makers can then utilise this understanding to inform their choices and conduct response options analysis.

Figure 9: Different types of decisions in an emergency



ENA outputs can be applied at various entry points within the emergency response process to support different types of decisions. For instance:

- **Situational Overview:** ENA outputs can support headquarters mobilisation by providing an overview of the situation, including the affected area, the number of people impacted, and key sectoral needs. This information, with a focus on the crisis profile and contextual information, helps inform National Society task force meetings, Disaster Relief Emergency Fund (DREF) requests, Emergency Appeals (EA), and Joint Task Force (JTF) briefings.
- **Operational Planning:** ENA insights on the impacts and realities on the ground, including damages, losses, people in need, and specific sectoral needs, are crucial for operational planning. This information, which also highlights response capacity and gaps, helps guide response options analyses, National Society response strategies, and the Operational Strategy (OS) and Implementation Plan (IP)
- **Advocacy:** ENA data on the extent of the crisis, its humanitarian impacts, and the gaps in the response can be leveraged for advocacy purposes. This information supports National Society communications, Emergency Appeals, IFRC/PNS communications, and PNS appeals, raising awareness and mobilising support within the global community.

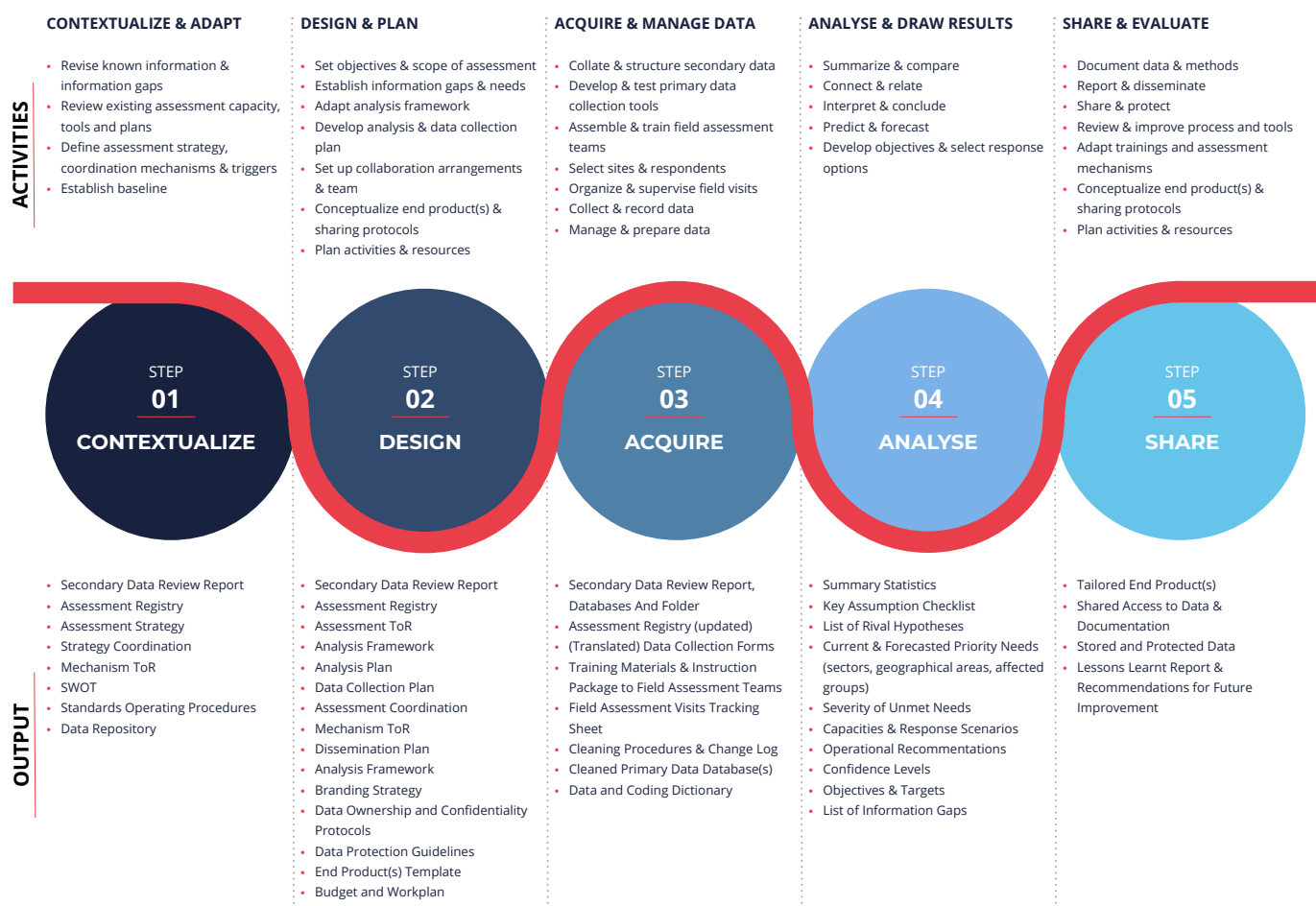
1.5. The Assessment Workflow

Assessments involve asking questions and refining them to obtain accurate answers, and ENAs are no exception. We need a structured set of questions that enable us to focus on the right information, formalise our arguments, build a strong case, and critically evaluate both our thinking and the data we collect.

To achieve this, we require a process that is both simple and adaptable, with questions at its core to drive discovery. This process is known as the "Assessment Workflow." The workflow comprises five stages: (1) Contextualize, (2) Design, (3) Acquire, (4) Analyse, and (5) Share. As illustrated in Figure 10 below, these stages are recursive and iterative. This means that we often need to revisit previous steps to refine our understanding, gather additional data, or adjust our methodology.

Chapter 3 of this guidance delves into each step of the assessment workflow, outlining how each stage builds upon the previous one. It demonstrates how the process can be scaled to meet the specific needs of the operation, ranging from small initial assessments to complex, detailed sectoral assessments.

Figure 10: Emergency Needs Assessment and Planning Process



1.6. ENA's Analytical Approach

An ENA facilitates understanding of a crisis by creating an emergency profile for a given situation. This profile provides key insights into the socio-economic context of the affected area, the drivers of the crisis, and the impacts on and capacities of those affected. It also highlights existing response capacities and identifies any gaps.

An ENA is structured around four key objectives:

- 1. Understanding the Context:** An assessment and analysis will differ depending on whether a similar disaster occurred in an urban or rural area, or in a country with no ongoing conflict versus one with a long history of internal violence and displacement. Understanding the context allows the team to adapt and design the most suitable ENA process for the specific operation. This is referred to as understanding the Crisis Profile.
- 2. Understanding What Happened:** An ENA seeks to understand what has transpired, what or who has been affected, and the extent of the impact. This is referred to as understanding the Crisis Impacts.
- 3. Understanding the Severity:** An ENA also aims to gauge the seriousness and criticality of the impacts. This enables the operation to prioritise activities based on sectoral needs, location, and specific groups affected by the severity of the conditions. This is referred to as understanding the Severity of Conditions.
- 4. Understanding the Response:** Finally, an ENA seeks to understand who is doing what and where in terms of the response, and whether any needs have been overlooked. This helps plan where to focus response efforts and avoid duplicating activities. This is referred to as understanding the Gaps in the Response.

Figure 11: ENA's four Objectives



These four objectives help identify the necessary information. Users are guided on how to approach an ENA and elaborate on these four objectives in a five-step assessment workflow, detailed in Chapter 3. Below is a set of key questions for each of the four objectives to help guide the analysis from the outset when considering an ENA. A detailed examination of the required analytical questions is part of Step 1 (Design) in the assessment workflow, and is explored further in Chapter 3. This serves as the starting point for determining your information needs and how they will inform decision-making.

Objectives and Measures [an analytical framework]

The ENA objectives are complemented by several analytical measures that collectively guide the collection and collation of assessment data. Importantly, this framework supports structured and focused analysis.

ENA Objectives and Indicators

Table 2 outlines the four objectives that an ENA seeks to explore and the associated measures that facilitate that exploration. It also presents how to approach each measure and the key questions that can be used to explore it.

Table 2: ENA Objectives and Indicators

Objective	Measure	How	Key questions
Crisis Profile <i>[Context]</i>	Pre-crisis vulnerability	Background information on identified pre-existing problems, vulnerabilities, and risks that might have a humanitarian impact on an unfolding crisis.	• What are the demographic characteristics of the population? • What are the main geographical characteristics of the area? • What are the main economic activities and trends? • What is the administrative and political structure? • What is the historical profile of the area in terms of conflicts, disasters, and trends? • Are there any Protection, Gender or Inclusion analyses available for the geographical area?
	Shock / crisis trigger	Descriptive Information on the event(s) that produced an undesirable effect on a given territory and population	• What was the shock that caused the crisis? • What was the size/scale of the shock that occurred? • Is this type of shock common for this location? • What event or combination of events triggered the crisis?
	Humanitarian profile	This should look at classification of affected population groups in a given territory in an emergency response (Total, Affected, In Need, Targeted, Reached, and Covered).	• How many people are affected by the crisis? • How many people are displaced due to the crisis? • Are the camps informal/formal, how many? How many people are in them? • How many non-displaced people are there? • How many host households are there? • How many people are injured, dead, or missing?
	Operational constraints	Information on how people in need are able to reach and be reached by humanitarian aid. It covers the access of relief actors to the affected population, and the access of the affected population to key services.	• Are markets functioning and to what level compared to pre-crisis? • Can the affected population access markets? • Can the affected population access Humanitarian assistance? • What physical access constraints are there? • What security access constraints are there?

Objective	Measure	How	Key questions
Crisis Impact <i>[Scope and Scale]</i>	Drivers and aggravating factors	This should look at a Factor or set of factors that can expose people to suffering or life-threatening conditions. Also referred to as Underlying factors, which exacerbate the crisis or contribute to increased vulnerability, such as pre-existing food insecurity or lack of governance capacity.	• What is the level of food insecurity in the affected area? • Are there any gender inequalities? • Is there any social discrimination? • Are there specific groups that are remote and hard to reach? • How many people with disabilities are affected? • Are there any seasonal factors that could be impacting the situation (e.g., lean season)?
	Systems disruption	Information about systems and networks that cease to function and impact service delivery, with potential or confirmed effects on availability and quality of those services and goods.	• Is there disruption to: ◦ Education services? ◦ Social security? ◦ Housing? ◦ Health care? ◦ Markets? ◦ Trading? ◦ Public administration services?
	Damages and Losses	Damages is looking at information about total or partial destruction of infrastructure and physical assets. Whereas Losses is looking for changes in micro/macro economics related to lost/reduced income and/or assets.	• How many buildings/infrastructure have been damaged and destroyed? • What types of buildings/infrastructure have been damaged and destroyed? • What assets have households lost? • What assets have businesses lost? • How have market chains been affected, and the associated impact on business and customers?

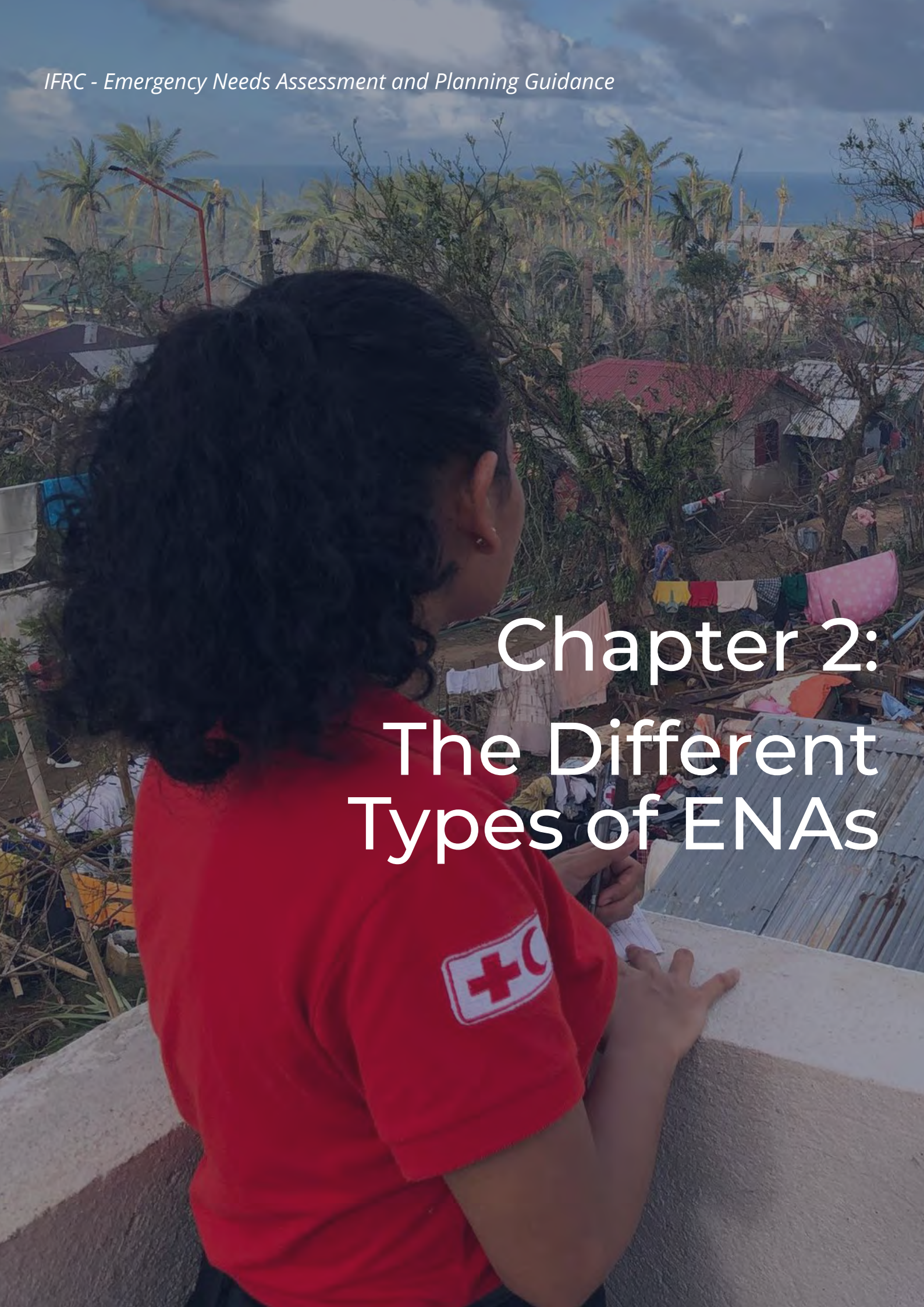
Objective	Measure	How	Key questions
Severity of Conditions <i>[Humanitarian conditions]</i>	Impact on accessibility, availability, quality, use and awareness of goods and services	This should look at the direct humanitarian consequences faced by the affected population and information related to access, availability, awareness, use and quality of basic/essential goods and services.	• What are people's level of access to? ◦ Drinking water? ◦ Sanitation Facilities? ◦ NFIs? ◦ Health care? ◦ Marketplaces? ◦ Shelter? ◦ Education? ◦ Livelihoods/finances? • Are people aware of how to access support? • Do people have access to information? If so, how?
	Impact on physical and mental well being	Looking for information on secondary effects occurring as a result of the crisis, which are directly affecting the physical and mental health of the affected population.	• Has there been a change in the level of food security as a result of the crisis? • What health data is available and has there been a rise in specific health cases (e.g., malaria/diarrhoea)? • Are there reports of gender-based violence? • Has there been a change in the level of malnutrition as a result of the crisis?
	1. Risks and vulnerability 2. Vulnerability and specific needs 3. Coping mechanisms 4. Early & self-recovery	This section should be looking for: 1. Situations that could potentially deteriorate and increase suffering if needs are not met. 2. Diminished capacity of an individual or group to anticipate, cope with, resist, and/or recover from a disaster. 3. Strategies or activities adopted by people, organisations, and systems, using available skills and resources, to manage adverse conditions, risk or disasters. 4. Information on the process of people's lives returning to normal in the immediate aftermath of a disaster.	• What risks could there be in the short- and medium-term that could make the situation worse? • What are the urgent needs that if not met could make the situation worse in the short- and medium-term? • What is the seasonal calendar? • What negative coping strategies have been observed? • What steps would be required for individuals to start to recover?

Objective	Measure	How	Key questions
Gaps in the Response <i>[Capacity and response]</i>	National Society capacity	This should look at governance, national, branch/chapter, and community levels, it should consider surge impact, exit strategy, and NS response capacity, as well as potential gaps, through transition within multilateral and bilateral programming.	• What is the National Society's mandate and interaction with national response systems? • What is the National Society's level of political power in relation within the national context. • What is the National Society's capacity to respond? ◦ Number of staff? ◦ Number of volunteers? ◦ Knowledge and experience? ◦ Resources such as vehicles and warehouses? ◦ Administration capacity (e.g., ability to process large amounts of funds quickly).
	National capacity and response	Information on the combination of strengths and resources within the community, society, government, or national organisations being used to respond to a crisis.	• What capacity does the government have to respond to the crisis? • What local community capacity is there to respond? • What capacity do local organisations have to respond? • How many local actors are responding and where? • What gaps are there in the local response (e.g., sectors not supported)?
	International response	Looking for Information on the combination of strengths and resources within international organisations, UN agencies, donors, and foreign governments being used to respond to a crisis.	• Who is responding to the crisis and in what capacity? • Where are international organisations responding? • What is being provided by international organisations (e.g., NFIs)? • What level of international media attention is the response getting? • What level of funding are responding organisations receiving?

Chapter 1 - Conclusion

Chapter 1 has successfully introduced the key concept of Emergency Needs Assessment (ENA), its significance, and its application within the humanitarian response context. The chapter provided a solid foundation for understanding the scope, purpose, and methodology of ENA, preparing the reader for the more detailed guidance in the next chapters.

As we move forward, the subsequent chapters will delve deeper into the specific types of ENAs, the step-by-step assessment workflow, and the essential resources and tools available to facilitate effective needs assessments. Armed with this foundational understanding from Chapter 1, readers will be well-equipped to navigate the complexities of the ENA process and contribute to informed decision-making and impactful humanitarian response efforts.

A woman with dark curly hair, wearing a red t-shirt with a white cross and crescent symbol on the sleeve, is seen from the side, looking out over a village. The village appears to be in a state of recovery or reconstruction, with many trees and buildings damaged or partially destroyed. Laundry is hanging on lines in the foreground. The sky is overcast.

Chapter 2: The Different Types of ENAs

Chapter 2: The Different Types of ENAs

The reader understands the scope of ENA, distinguishing what it encompasses and what falls outside its boundaries

2.1. Emergency Needs Assessments – Different Approaches for Different Contexts

Understanding the needs of people affected by disasters and crises, as well as the broader context in which they occur, is crucial for informing humanitarian response approaches and modalities across the IFRC. ENAs serve as a vital tool for gathering, analysing, and interpreting data on situations of concern. They can be conducted before, during, and after the peak of emergency needs, adapting to various small and large-scale disasters and crises.

There are numerous approaches to conducting an ENA, with adaptations based on factors such as the trigger event, primary research questions, context, timeframe, and available capacity. Additionally, each National Society adheres to its own doctrine and fulfils a specific role within the national disaster management framework.

This guidance presents the fundamental principles and common practices underlying ENAs, applicable to slow-onset, sudden-onset, or complex emergencies/crises. While the core components of ENAs remain consistent, the specific approach can be tailored to different contexts.

Risk Assessment

Identifying communities most at risk from hazards and understanding their capacities and resilience strategies is crucial for informing contingency planning and early response actions. Most Red Cross and Red Crescent National Societies conduct Vulnerability and Capacity Assessments (VCAs) and other risk mapping exercises to target resilience-building interventions and contingency plans. A self-assessment conducted under the National Society's Preparedness for Effective Response process helps identify strengths and gaps, further informing potential response options. Planning based on pre-agreed triggers for specific hazards, including through Forecast-based Action, may have already pre-selected early actions. The National Society's role as an auxiliary to the government within the national disaster management framework might include relaying disaster alerts and public messages to minimise or mitigate impacts.

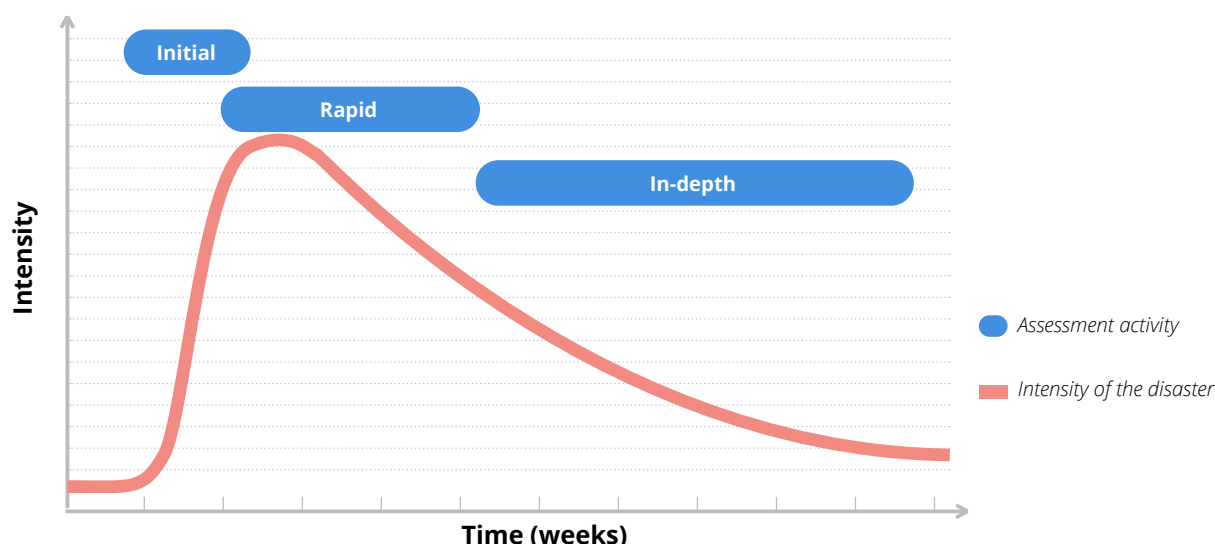
Sudden Onset Emergencies (e.g., earthquake/explosion/flood):

In sudden-onset emergencies, information is urgently needed to guide immediate action. Initial and/or rapid assessments are crucial for informing emergency decisions and priorities, often reflected in a DREF (Disaster Relief Emergency Fund) request. Speed is paramount in such contexts. A preliminary snapshot of the situation, based on partial information and presented simply, is necessary. This snapshot should draw upon previous crises and modelled impact estimates, acknowledging the inherent uncertainty and potential lack of contextual interpretation.

As the response progresses, assessments should employ more robust qualitative and quantitative methods, potentially adopting a staggered approach that links previous assessments to subsequent, more substantive ones. This approach ensures regular updates on the conditions of affected populations, informing the operational strategy.

While speed and relative simplicity are important initially, it is crucial to proactively assess risks specific to distinct groups within the affected population. Regular safety checks and service mappings are considered best practices for identifying and mitigating immediate Sexual and Gender-Based Violence (SGBV) risks. Direct observation and safety checks can assess risks related to WASH (Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene), camp layout, resource availability, and physical access constraints. Interviews and discussions with service providers can complement service mapping efforts.

Figure 12: Sudden Onset Emergencies - Intensity of Assessment Activity over time

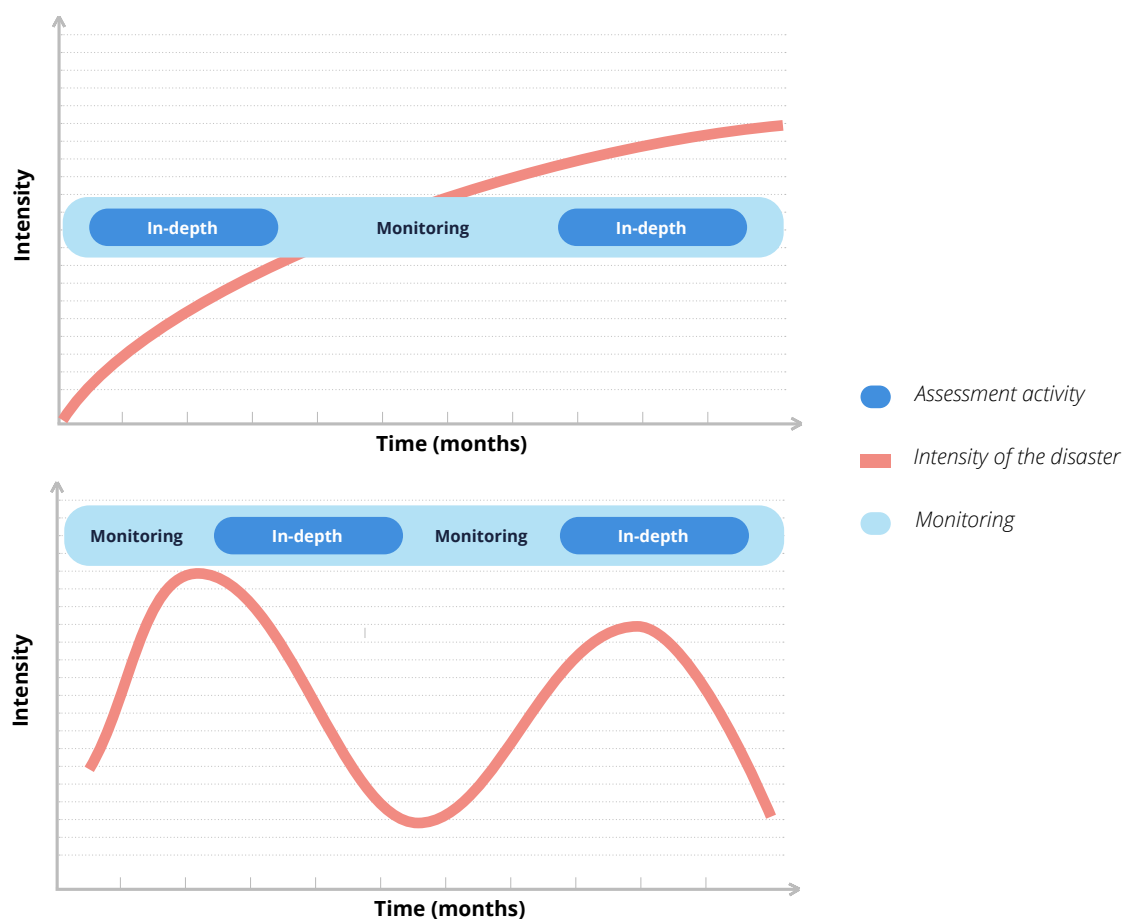


Slow Onset Emergencies (e.g., drought/migration/desertification):

In slow onset crises, the progression is more gradual and predictable, allowing for better-defined decision-making timeframes and planning. Rapid multi-sectoral or in-depth sectoral needs assessments conducted at regular intervals can effectively inform medium- and long-term planning.

Each assessment should employ a comparable methodology to enable trend analysis. A secondary data review, conducted before or between assessment cycles, is crucial for building upon existing knowledge and information from partners in the response.

Figure 13: Slow Onset Emergencies - Intensity of Assessment Activity over time

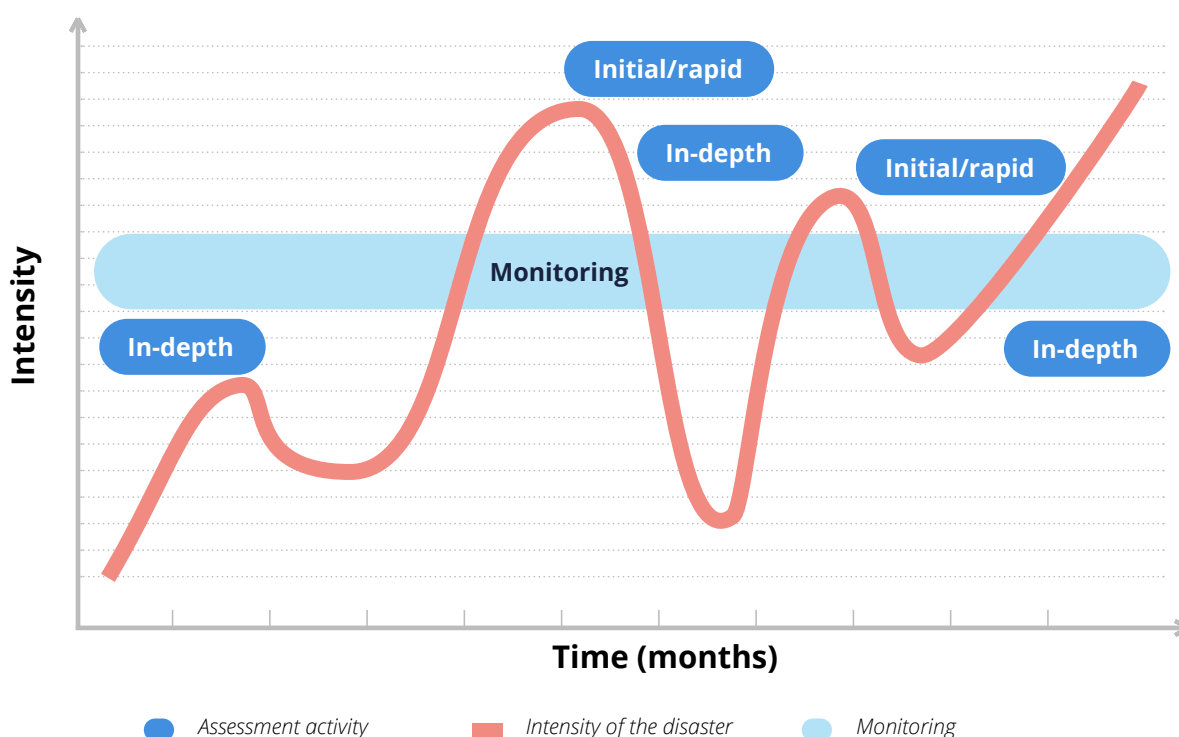


Complex Emergencies (e.g., prolonged conflict and political instability)

Complex emergencies are characterised by high unpredictability, with potential for multiple cycles of violence or crisis escalations. These contexts can be both stable and unstable, varying by location and time. Operations in such environments benefit from identifying potential trends through regular analysis of situational monitoring data, which may trigger further needs assessments.

The choice and sequencing of assessments depend heavily on stability and safety. In stable and accessible contexts, any assessment type may be suitable. However, in unstable situations, initial and rapid assessments might be the only feasible options. In-depth assessments in unstable areas must consider the expected level of change and its impact on the validity of collected information over time.

Figure 14: Complex Emergencies - Intensity of Assessment Activity over time



2.2. Adapting ENA to the Type of Crisis

Different contexts necessitate different assessment approaches. All operations, regardless of their type, scale, or complexity, require an assessment strategy (established in step 1 of the assessment workflow) that is clearly linked to decision-making. Ensuring that the strategy is adaptable and suitable for the operational context is key to effectively delivering insights and understanding the needs of affected populations, ultimately informing the response strategy. By linking different types and sequences of assessments within a cohesive assessment strategy, National Societies and the wider IFRC can significantly enhance the efficiency and effectiveness of services provided to those in need.

Types of Emergency Need Assessments

Once the type of crisis has been identified, an appropriate assessment strategy can be developed. As outlined previously, each type of disaster or crisis presents unique assessment requirements. The three main types of assessments are: (1) Initial, (2) Rapid, and (3) In-Depth. An effective assessment strategy for a crisis may involve a combination of these three types. In addition to these, there's a fourth type: needs monitoring (also referred to as continual assessment).

It is important to remember that the timeframes listed below for each assessment type are indicative and can vary depending on the specific situation. For instance, completing an in-depth assessment within 30 days might be feasible in a geographically limited crisis but not in one with a vast affected area. The key is to conduct the right assessment(s) at the right time to meet the operational needs.

Preparedness

Preparedness is crucial for effective assessments. Establishing capacity, knowledge, and tools before an event significantly enhances the speed and effectiveness of the ENA process. While preparedness activities fall outside the scope of this document, they are vital for ENA and align with existing initiatives like National Society Preparedness for Effective Response (PER). The NS and its key partners, including the IFRC, ICRC, and PNSs, are encouraged to:

- Define priorities and allocate financial and human resources, such as National Response Teams (NRT), Branch Response Teams (BRT), volunteers, etc.
- Engage leadership, directors, and operational teams in the ENA process.
- Understand the expected roles of the National Society, partners, and country stakeholders.
- Understand the country context, including identifying high-risk geographical areas, key national DM documents, and the legal framework.
- Establish key secondary datasets to identify specific at-risk groups, considering factors like gender, disability, age, language, ethnicity, and other diversity aspects such as language, religion, or culture.
- Understand local community structures and the information ecosystem, including trusted communication channels.
- Integrate ENA into disaster and crisis response mechanisms and SOPs, including simulations and early warning actions.
- Ensure effective team deployment and coordination, including training, equipping, and insuring assessment teams.

Initial Assessment

An initial assessment is recommended within the first 48 hours to determine the scale, severity, and projected evolution of the crisis. It should be conducted jointly with the National Society and key partners in the country.

Difficulty	Low
OUTPUT	Emergency Appeal/DREF or initial NS plan of action
FOCUS	Priority needs of the affected population / Scale and severity of the impact
TIMEFRAME	Short (48-72 hrs)
SOURCES	Mostly secondary data sources, limited primary data from direct observation and key informant interviews (including NS volunteers), non-representative sampling
REPORT	NS sit-rep (or national equivalent) or inclusion in the DREF/Emergency Appeal
PARTNERS	Primarily the National Society, with Movement partners and the IFRC (in-country) if needed
RESOURCES	Government (local, regional, national), community disaster response teams (if available), key informants, etc.

Rapid Assessment

The rapid assessment informs the more detailed OS of the National Society, which may involve support from the IFRC and Movement partners. It should consider NS strategic priorities, long-term programme impacts, and drive the response options analysis.

Difficulty	Moderate
OUTPUT	Operational Strategy
FOCUS	Priority current and projected needs of the vulnerable groups and humanitarian priorities
TIMEFRAME	Moderate (from 7 to 14 days)
SOURCES	Secondary data (community information, DRR programs, surveillance mechanisms) and primary data collected purposefully in selected locations
REPORT	Evidence for Response Options Analysis and inclusion in the Operational Strategy/ Emergency Appeal
PARTNERS	National Society, Movement partners, and IFRC (in-country) where applicable
RESOURCES	Government, key informants, local NGOs, community representatives (ideally diverse), focus groups with at-risk groups, sectoral coordination system, external sources (ACAPS, UN agencies, INGOs, etc.)

In-Depth Assessments

In-depth assessments provide a nuanced understanding of community needs, considering how different groups are affected and identifying recovery pathways. The analysis also focuses on sectoral needs to support detailed programming for revising the plan of action and Emergency Appeal. Due to their focus on the individual and community levels, in-depth assessments are critical for recovery planning, linking emergency response to recovery and ensuring continuity.

Difficulty	High
OUTPUT	Revised/Updated Operational Strategy and Implementation Plan
FOCUS	Operational planning.
TIMEFRAME	Long (from 30 to 90 days)
SOURCES	Increasingly primary data sources / Monitoring of the programme and representative sampling
REPORT	Evidence to inform Response Options Analysis and Assessment report to inform the revised EA and Operational Strategy
PARTNERS	Volunteers, branches, National Society, Movement partners, and IFRC (in-country) where applicable
RESOURCES	Government, key informants, local NGOs, community representatives, sectoral coordination system, external sources

Continual Assessments - 30 days and onward

Continual assessments occur after a detailed assessment and the Movement is operational in an area. Often associated with the transition from emergency response to recovery, they involve regular updates on the situation and beneficiary feedback to inform long-term decision-making. Effective continual assessments help identify changes, triggering rapid or detailed assessments when needed. Information gathered during continual assessments serves as secondary data for future assessments.

2.3. Other Types of Assessments in Emergencies

Emergency operations are complex and often unpredictable, requiring adaptable data collection methods and diverse assessment types. It is essential to tailor emergency needs assessments to meet the specific operational needs of each situation.

This section introduces additional assessment types that, while not previously mentioned, should often be incorporated into an operation's assessment strategy.

Rapid Assessment of Markets (RAM):

Understanding market functionality is crucial for analysing appropriate response options. Therefore, a Rapid Assessment of Markets (RAM) should typically be included in most ENA analysis and data collection plans.

- **Purpose:** Evaluates the functionality of markets and the availability of essential goods and services in crisis-affected areas.
- **Significance:** Informs cash-based interventions and market-based programming, ensuring aid reaches those in need efficiently and effectively.

The RAM is an instrument allowing humanitarian practitioners with limited market expertise and time to develop a rapid and basic understanding of key markets within the first few days after a shock.

The RAM is designed to provide a quick and basic first understanding of key markets in the immediate aftermath of a shock. The RAM strengthens response analysis by providing market data, essential for informed decision-making on appropriate transfer mechanisms (i.e., in-kind or cash-based) if relief is to be provided. The tools used in the RAM, such as market mapping tools, can also reveal possibilities for market-support interventions and identify entry points to support market recovery. Therefore, the RAM is not biased towards a specific form of response but facilitates reflection about a wide range of response options.

It should be noted that the RAM **does not assess the need for relief**; this is the purpose of an ENA. Strictly speaking, the RAM can be used to analyse any commodity market – that is, it can be used for goods and services. However, the focus of attention in the immediate aftermath of a shock will typically be on goods.

Learn More: [Cash in Emergencies toolkit - RAM](#)

In-Depth Assessment - Recovery:

Assessing for recovery is an integral part of the function of emergency operations and falls within the operational timeline for a response. In the past it has been seen as a separate process and referred to as a standalone Recovery Assessment. This is not the case; a Recovery Assessment is just an In-Depth assessment that considers aspects of recovery.

- **Purpose:** Examines the long-term needs of communities affected by crises, identifying opportunities for recovery and resilience-building.
- **Significance:** Guides the transition from immediate relief to sustainable recovery and development initiatives.

Ultimately, emergency operations aim to support communities to recover from crises and ensure that they are more resilient to future shocks. As such, we need to have a good understanding of the pre-crisis situation, as well as of the impact of the crisis. This means complementing secondary data with in-depth assessments that can identify and analyse not only the needs but also: the risks faced by communities, who is vulnerable, what coping mechanisms are being used by vulnerable groups and affected communities, what capacities exist in communities, and how self-recovery is likely to progress. If we don't understand these factors, we are unlikely to be able to support recovery effectively.

Assessing and planning for recovery requires us to bring some community-based development and resilience thinking into the post-crisis context. Adopting a participatory approach is essential. National Societies can utilise some of the participatory approaches they use in long-term programming, such as the tools from the Enhanced VCA methodology, to help build a better understanding of affected communities.

Example tool: [Livelihoods Assessment Tool-Kit \(LAT\)](#)

Environmental Assessment:

- **Purpose:** Assesses the environmental impacts of crises and humanitarian responses, ensuring sustainable and eco-friendly practices.
- **Significance:** Promotes responsible environmental management and minimises the negative ecological consequences of disasters and aid efforts.

Ensuring that environmental impacts are considered in humanitarian action as early as possible makes a huge difference to both people and the environment. This includes not just the environmental impacts caused by the disaster or crisis, but also the potential environmental risks of the planned response and recovery operation. Environmental stewardship during humanitarian action reduces conflict drivers and increases resilience. Timely planning, identification of key needs and issues, and integration of environmental considerations before and during humanitarian action can help save lives and preserve and restore human livelihoods. Coping mechanisms available to communities, and their ability to recover from crises, can be severely affected by a degraded local environment.

Humanitarian organisations approach the environmental assessment of their programmes and projects in different ways. Some use an environmental checklist or marker (sometimes complemented by social elements such as gender and age), some use an environmental screening tool, while occasionally some may employ a detailed environmental impact assessment (especially if construction or infrastructure is involved).

Within emergency contexts, there will be less time for detailed assessments in the early phases. As activities move towards recovery, there is time and opportunity to address environmental risk and a more detailed screening or assessment can be conducted. Our emphasis is to ensure that everyone involved in a response is considering the environmental context and how their planned response and recovery activities could impact the environment. There are environmental screening tools available now which are designed for DM generalists to use, which do not require specialist environmental skills, and only take one day to complete. Where possible these can be integrated into an In-Depth Assessment.

Example tool: [NEAT+](#)

Post Distribution Monitoring (PDM):

- **Purpose:** Monitors the distribution and utilisation of aid, ensuring it reaches the intended beneficiaries and meets their needs.
- **Significance:** Enhances accountability, transparency, and the overall effectiveness of humanitarian assistance.

PDM is a tool which aims at the systematic collection and analysis of information of the project as it progresses. It provides management with valid information, which can be used to assess the efficiency of various project

inputs and the effectiveness of that project in terms of meeting the set objectives. It provides a whole range of information from targeting, registration, obtaining information on the usage of cash transferring modalities, and the usage of the community help desks at distribution points. It also assesses the beneficiary's satisfaction with the registration and distribution processes.

Its results are largely quantitative and highlight broad trends in order to inform programming. Data is collected through interviews with individual (or groups of) beneficiaries based on a sample survey format. Results of a PDM are used to feed back into the project cycle in order to improve the way assistance is designed and delivered. They are responsive to the preferences of beneficiaries and sensitive to potential protection risks and market distortions that could be caused by the assistance.

Example tool: [Shelter Cluster PDM toolkit](#)

Vulnerability and Capacity Assessment (VCA):

- **Purpose:** A participatory process where communities, with Red Cross Red Crescent support, assess their own risks, vulnerabilities, and capacities to cope with disasters.
- **Significance:** Provides valuable pre-disaster insights into community vulnerabilities and capacities, aiding preparedness and response planning. Can also offer valuable community-level data post-emergency if established beforehand.

The VCA is a participatory community risk assessment process. It enables communities, with the support of National Societies when needed, to assess and analyse the risks they face, explore where these risks come from, which members of the community are most exposed, what coping capacities are available, and what initiatives can be undertaken to strengthen coping capacities and reduce the risks.

VCAs take time and resources to set up and establish, and are not something commonly approached in an emergency context. That said, if the National society has invested in establishing these beforehand, they can provide excellent insight into the ENA process. They can also act as an excellent source of community level data post emergency, again if they have been established beforehand.

Example tool: [EVCA toolkit](#)

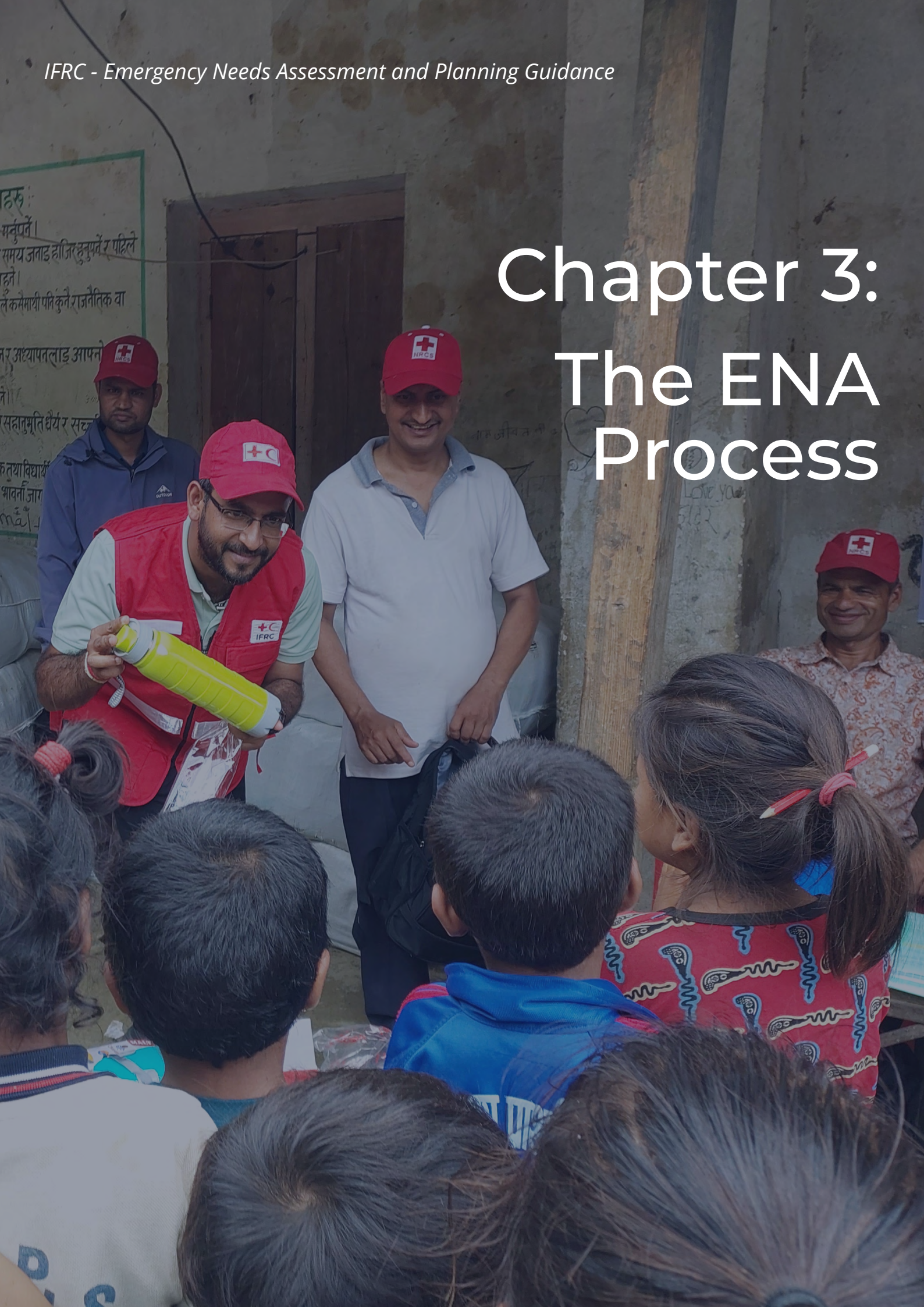
These represent just a few examples of the diverse assessment tools available to humanitarian practitioners. The specific assessments used will depend on the nature of the crisis, the information needs, and the available resources. By utilising a combination of these approaches, organisations can gain a comprehensive understanding of the situation and make informed decisions to address the complex needs of affected populations.

Chapter 2 - Conclusion

In this chapter, we explored the various types of ENAs, each with its own strengths, limitations, and ideal applications. The selection and sequencing of these assessments depend heavily on the nature of the crisis, available resources, and desired outcomes. Whether responding to a sudden-onset disaster, a slow-onset crisis, or a complex emergency, choosing the right assessment approach is crucial for gathering timely and relevant information to inform effective decision-making and response planning.

Remember, the ENA process is not a one-size-fits-all solution. It requires careful consideration of the context, preparedness, and adaptability to ensure that the assessment meets the specific needs of the situation and ultimately contributes to a more impactful and coordinated humanitarian response.

Chapter 3: The ENA Process



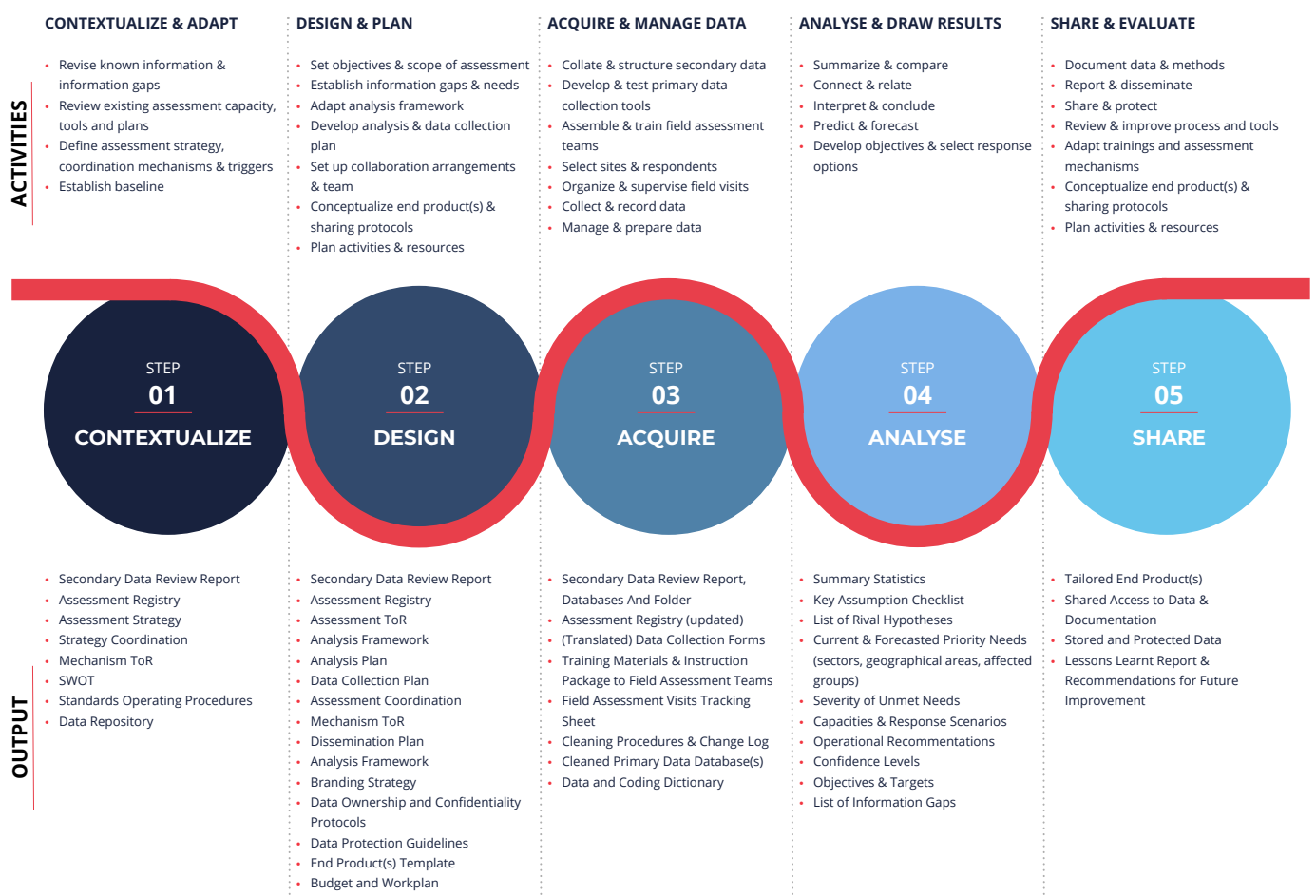
Chapter 3: The ENA Process

The reader is introduced to the assessment workflow, a systematic approach to conducting an assessment and understands the key phases involved.

How It's Done - The Assessment Workflow

The assessment workflow offers a structured, step-by-step approach to designing and implementing effective ENAs. While tailored for ENAs, this workflow can be adapted to any assessment process. The workflow is divided into five stages: (1) Contextualize, (2) Design, (3) Collect, (4) Analyse, and (5) Share. These stages are recursive and iterative, allowing for flexibility to revisit and adjust the approach as needed. This iterative nature is crucial, as it enables us to refine our understanding, gather additional data, or modify our methodology based on emerging insights.

As discussed in Chapter 2, the assessment strategy (developed in step 1 of the workflow) defines the specific types of ENAs utilised in the operation. The workflow itself can be applied at different phases of the emergency operation, transitioning from rapid assessments in the initial stages to more detailed assessments as the situation evolves. This adaptability makes the workflow valuable throughout the entire emergency or crisis response. For example, insights and lessons learned from an initial assessment conducted within the first 72 hours can inform and streamline subsequent, more comprehensive assessments.



ENA Toolkit

The following sections delve deeper into the workflow, presenting a comprehensive toolkit for conducting ENAs. Each step of the process is explored, outlining key activities and expected outputs. In it you will also find links to specific tools and resources relevant to each activity, accompanied by illustrative examples of the outputs.

3.1. Step 1: Contextualise [Strategic]

Key supporting material: CHECKLIST Understand the Context [C3.1.11](#) | TOOL Analysis canvas [C3.1.9](#)

Overview

Before embarking on any assessment, it is crucial to thoroughly analyse the pre-existing context and key drivers of the situation, even in rapidly evolving sudden-onset emergencies. This analysis lays the groundwork for a strategic way forward. To achieve this, we begin by reviewing existing knowledge about the context, including information on population groups and any factors contributing to risk or vulnerability. It is equally important to identify any information gaps and formulate research questions that need to be addressed. Furthermore, it is vital to assess available resources and coordination mechanisms that can facilitate the implementation of the assessment and effectively utilise the insights gained.

In essence, this first step involves thoughtfully adapting general ENA guidance to suit the specific operational context. The primary outcome of this stage is a comprehensive assessment strategy, outlining key actions, reporting approach, team composition, standard operating procedures, and other relevant details.

Note: Every operation will present different challenges, and every ENA process should be adapted to meet them. The following list of activities should be approached with a level of flexibility and adaptability. What matters is that the quality and usefulness of the ENA is good enough for decision-making. To help identify essential vs desirable outputs, the notation ^E is used for essential and ^D for desirable.

Key activities

- **Review known information & information gaps**

Explore assessments conducted internally or externally (National Society branches or local/thematic units might possess valuable information). Gain insights into events and their locations. Analyse reported impacts and identify any unreported or missing information. The crucial objective here is to recognize knowledge gaps that necessitate further assessment. Utilising an analytical framework, even a basic one, proves effective in exploring what is known and what remains unknown.

Outputs

- **Established key baselines ^E**

It is also crucial to establish key baseline datasets on population demographics and pre-crisis levels of access to essential services like health, water, and sanitation. Data preparedness can significantly contribute here; relevant data can be collected and collated before a crisis occurs. The ENA analytical framework aids in outlining the required information. Consult the IFRC GO platform for historical crisis data, operational learning, and preparedness data.

- **Secondary data snapshot ^E** Template [C3.1.1a](#) | Example [C3.1.1b](#)

A concise document summarising the situation, highlighting the events, geographical extent, and severity of the impact (if possible). It should also identify known information gaps, such as those related to gender and diversity.

- **Assessment registry ^D** Template [C3.1.2a](#) | Example [C3.1.2b](#) | [Resource](#)

A tool to track completed and planned assessments, including who conducted them and where. This helps identify available information sources and gaps. It is a dynamic document that should be updated regularly and shared within the operation and with partners to avoid duplication.

- **Secondary Data repository** ^E [Template C3.1.3a](#) | [Example C3.1.3b](#)

Organised around a suitable analytical framework (like the ENA framework), this repository captures relevant secondary data. Simple methods like whiteboards, sticky notes, or Excel spreadsheets can be used. Close collaboration with Information Management coordinators is crucial to ensure this is a shared resource for the operation.

- **Review assessment capacity, tools, and plans**

Understanding the capacity available to conduct an ENA is crucial for effective assessment planning. This also presents an opportunity to identify any capacity gaps and request support from IFRC Surge mechanisms. A candid and realistic assessment of your ENA capabilities is essential. A small-scale, well-executed initial assessment often proves more valuable than a poorly resourced rapid assessment or an incomplete in-depth assessment.

Outputs

- **SWOT analysis** ^E [Template C3.1.4a](#) | [Example C3.1.4b](#)

A strategic planning technique to identify Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats related to an ENA within the operational context.

- **Resource and gaps list** ^E [Template C3.1.6a](#) | [Example C3.1.6b](#)

An inventory of available staff, volunteers, equipment, tools, and financial resources. This might not be exhaustive and should leverage existing National Society resources if possible. This list facilitates comparisons between current capabilities and anticipated resource requirements for the ENA.

- **Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)** ^E

A set of step-by-step instructions to guide the execution of ENA tasks, promoting efficiency, quality output, and consistency while minimising miscommunication. Existing SOPs within the context should be reviewed and adapted as needed. If SOPs don't exist and time allows outside of an operation, they can be developed as part of preparedness activities. However, during an active operation, creating detailed SOPs is often impractical.

- **Define assessment strategy and coordination**

An assessment strategy should be grounded in a thorough understanding of the current context, information gaps, and overall assessment needs. This strategy serves as the overarching plan guiding all subsequent assessments. The document should clearly articulate the aims and objectives of the entire ENA process, not just individual assessments, while also providing a clear scope and scale for the activities, timeframes, and expected outputs.

Additionally, either alongside or incorporated within the strategy, there should be an outline of who to coordinate with regarding assessments and how this coordination will occur. This coordination can be internal, external, or both. It is essential to specify the intended level of coordination and key touchpoints (e.g., working group meetings). The strategy may also extend to outlining the roles and responsibilities of those involved in the assessment process.

Outputs

- **Assessment strategy** ^E [Template C3.1.7a](#) | [Example C3.1.7b](#) | [Tool C3.1.9](#)

Outlines the aim, objectives, scope, and scale of the planned ENA, specifying the timeframe, resources, key activities, and expected deliverables.

- **Coordination strategy** ^E [Template C3.1.8a](#) | [Example C3.1.8b](#)

The coordination component of the strategy should detail both internal and external engagement, specifying the intended level of collaboration and key touchpoints. It may also delineate the roles and responsibilities of involved parties.

3.2. Step 2: Design [Tactical]

Overview

This stage transitions an ENA into tactical planning, concentrating on the practicalities of the assessment: how, when, where, with whom, and what the focus will be. Essentially, this stage transforms the strategy into an actionable plan.

It is tempting to rush into data collection and analysis during an assessment, but this is counterproductive. Just as in step 1, it is advisable to invest time in designing and planning how the assessment strategy will be implemented and what questions need answering. Even in rapidly evolving emergencies with tight timeframes, dedicating even a short period of time to focused planning can significantly improve the quality of the assessment outcomes. Remember, the assessment workflow is iterative, so each step can be built upon, revised, or enhanced later on.

Note: Every operation will present different challenges, and every ENA process should be adapted to meet them. The following list of activities should be approached with a level of flexibility and adaptability. What matters is that the quality and usefulness of the ENA is good enough for decision-making. To help identify essential vs desirable outputs, the notation ^E is used for essential and ^D for desirable.

Key activities

- **Set objective and scope of assessment**

Clearly outlining the purpose of each assessment is essential to ensure it remains focused and addresses specific information gaps and needs. The objective should explicitly state the key requirements of each assessment and align with the overall assessment strategy. The scope should be well-defined, encompassing the geographical extent, targeted population groups, the desired level of detail or granularity of information, and the types of sectoral information needed.

Outputs

- **Assessment Plan of Action (PoA)** ^E Template [C3.2.1a](#) | Example [C3.2.1b](#)

This document serves as an effective framework for outlining the objectives and scope of each assessment, ensuring accessibility of relevant information for all involved. It can also highlight additional details such as specific resources, timeframes, and security requirements. A single Plan of Action can be drafted for the entire ENA, or multiple plans can be created for each component within the ENA.

- **Adapt Analytical framework**

The ENA Objectives and associated measures are fundamental to organising secondary and primary data and provide a structure for the assessment process. The Design phase should be seen as an opportunity to revisit the current Objectives and Measures (as proposed in Chapter 1) and make any necessary adjustments based on the current context and operational needs. In some cases, no changes may be required.

Outputs

- **ENA Objectives and Measures** ^E Resource [C3.2.2](#)

Discussed extensively in Chapter 1, this analytical framework guides data management, acting as a repository for collating, storing, and analysing secondary and primary data related to the areas of understanding. It facilitates structured analysis, leading to the identification of key findings that inform decision-making.

• Develop analysis and data collection plan

This is the most crucial aspect of step 2, where you transform the operation's key understandings into tangible Measures with defined indicators. This focus ensures the assessment is efficient, coordinated, and delivers operationally relevant insights to support decision-making.

Outputs

- **Analysis Plan** ^E [Template C3.2.3a](#) | [Example C3.2.3b](#) | [Checklist C3.2.2](#)

Details how collected information will be used to answer key operational questions, utilising the analytical framework for structure. For each Measure, one or more indicators are identified for measurement and subsequent interpretation within the framework.

- **Data collection plan** ^E [Template C3.2.3a](#) | [Example C3.2.3b](#) | [Checklist 24hr C3.2.11a](#) | [Checklist 72hr C3.2.11b](#)

An extension of the analysis plan, outlining the best data collection techniques, sources of information, and specific questions and response options for field-level data collection related to each indicator. This plan should be developed in collaboration with Information Management coordinators or, if applicable, SIMS and ERU IM in IFRC-supported operations.

- **Protected and secured data** ^E [Checklist C3.2.4](#)

Depending on the type of data collected, some may be classified as personal or sensitive, requiring protection in accordance with data protection guidelines and regulations. This applies to both primary and acquired secondary data. The specific approach may vary, but data protection measures must be adhered to and enforced.

• Set up collaboration arrangements

The assessment strategy will specify the extent to which the assessment will be coordinated, harmonised, or uncoordinated. This determination necessitates planning in terms of logistics, resources, timeframes, and the geographical distribution of assessments.

Furthermore, it is crucial to outline who owns the data, how it will be shared between organisations, its sensitivity, and what information can and cannot be shared due to these sensitivities. This is an often overlooked yet vital step.

Outputs

- **Data Protection** ^D [Checklist C3.2.4](#) | [Guidance](#)

This can range from simple to complex, tailored to the specific situation. The more time available to establish data protection measures, the better. Preparedness activities should ideally include exploring these measures. At a minimum, it should outline key elements such as data ownership, storage, sharing protocols, and what information can and cannot be shared.

- **Assessment Coordination** ^D [Checklist C3.2.5](#)

This is especially vital for coordinated assessments, but even harmonised or uncoordinated assessments should review existing arrangements for assessment coordination. This can involve establishing Terms of Reference (ToRs), scheduling meetings, or forming a working group. It could even be as simple as using a whiteboard to track assessment activities. The key is to ensure that all relevant parties are connected through appropriate channels.

• Conceptualise end products and sharing protocols

Early consideration of how assessment results will be shared can help determine the necessary information to be collected. Essentially, this means clearly stating how ENA information will be presented and disseminated.

A key aspect is identifying the primary audiences for the ENA data and insights, then tailoring end products to their specific needs and preferences. It is also crucial to recognize any established reporting requirements, specific timeframes, and sensitivities surrounding certain information that might necessitate sharing findings in a particular manner or time. In short, this step is about ensuring findings reach the right audiences at the right time, in a format that is both accessible and useful.

Outputs

- **End product(s) templates** ^D *Templates [Initial [C3.2.12](#)] [Rapid [C3.2.13](#)] [scenario reporting [C3.2.14](#)]*

Templates for Initial, Rapid, In-depth, and Scenario Reporting. The design of end products should bridge the gap between findings and audience. Consider how the audience best absorbs information and balance this with the level of detail needed. Planning this beforehand ensures timely delivery of relevant information in a suitable format, streamlining the transition from analysis (step 4) to sharing (step 5) in the workflow. The provided templates serve as a starting point, and additional products may be beneficial depending on the situation.

- **Dissemination plan and product pipeline** ^D *Example Dissemination Plan [C3.2.6](#) | Example Product pipeline [C3.2.7](#)*

Understanding when to share the products is helpful not only for assessment team planning but also for the wider operation to anticipate information delivery. A clear and accessible dissemination plan keeps key audiences informed and engaged in the assessment process. A product pipeline details the steps involved in preparing products for dissemination; essentially, it is a detailed workplan focused on the products.

• Plan activities and resources

This step may seem self-explanatory and closely related to the assessment Plan of Action (PoA) mentioned previously. In reality, it serves to build upon and elaborate on the PoA. At this stage, it is recommended to create an operational workplan and budget documents. These are commonly developed using Excel, but other tools like MS Project can be employed depending on the scale of the work.

Outputs

- **Budget** ^E *Template [C3.2.10a](#) | Example [C3.2.10b](#)*

A document outlining the resources required to conduct the assessment and their associated costs. It can also be used to itemise costs for each aspect of the assessment process. It may be helpful to categorise costs into running costs versus operational costs.

- **Workplan** ^E *Template [C3.2.9a](#) | Example [C3.2.9b](#)*

A document that varies in detail based on the context, but at a minimum, it should outline key assessment activities, their timing and location, duration, and current status.

- **Additional resources**

IFRC Rapid Assessment Toolkit (RAT) – Resource [C3.2.15](#)

The IFRC's Rapid Assessment Toolkit (RAT) facilitates the prioritisation of sectoral needs at sub-national levels (e.g., districts) by leveraging key informants, National Society expertise, and secondary data to comprehensively understand a crisis. The assessment analyses three core pillars: Crisis Impacts, Humanitarian Conditions, and Capacity to Respond, generating a crisis profile for affected areas. This profile enables the prioritisation of interventions and informs further detailed assessments.

This toolkit can be utilised in conjunction with this guidance and adapted to the specific context during step 2 (Design) of the assessment workflow.

Outputs

- **Sectoral Parameter Mapping Assessment SPMA** ^E | **Template** [C3.2.15](#)

This SPMA (Sectoral Parameter Mapping Assessment) framework was prepared to define suitable measures for each parameter (Access, Availability, Quality, Use [awareness]) at a minimal, moderate, and maximum for each sector (WASH, Food security, Health, Livelihoods, Shelter, and CEA).

- **Technical Key Informant Assessment (TKIA)** ^E | **Template** [C3.2.15](#)

The TKIA (Technical Key Informant Assessment) aims to gather technical insights into the situation, understand the severity of problems, identify vulnerable groups, and gauge preferred response modalities to plan effective activities for those affected by the crisis.

- **Initial Assessment Tool (IAT)** ^E | **Template** [C3.2.15](#)

The IAT (Initial Assessment Tool) aims to rapidly assess the overall situation in a district, identify priority areas and vulnerable groups, and understand the severity of problems and preferred response modalities to enable effective planning and resource allocation in a crisis.

- **Focus Group Discussion (FGD)** ^E | **Template** [C3.2.15](#)

The document provides instructions and guidelines for conducting focus group discussions (FGDs) to gather qualitative data about the impact of a specific event (referred to as "XXXXX") on communities. It outlines the purpose, preparation steps, participant selection criteria, and the flow of the discussion, including introductory scripts and ground rules.

- **Prioritization Report** ^E | **Template** [C3.2.15](#)

This report is designed to capture and organise data collected through various methods (interviews, focus groups, secondary data) to assess and prioritise sectoral needs in the context of a crisis. The template includes sections for detailing the assessment methodology, sampling strategy, demographic profile of participants, and in-depth analysis of each district's needs, challenges, and priorities across different sectors.

3.3. Step 3: Collect and Manage Data [Operational]

Overview

Once the ENA design is complete (step 2), the focus shifts to collecting and managing data. This is the operational stage where the ENA moves into the field (or remotely via secondary data) to acquire the necessary information. Effective management of the data collection process is crucial. This involves ensuring that tools are prepared and tested, staff and volunteers are trained and ready, field movements are coordinated safely and efficiently, and acquired data is securely stored and organised.

Note: Every operation will present different challenges, and every ENA process should be adapted to meet them. The following list of activities should be approached with a level of flexibility and adaptability. What matters is that the quality and usefulness of an ENA is good enough for decision-making. To help identify essential vs desirable outputs, the notation ^E is used for essential and ^D for desirable.

Key activities

- **Collect and structure secondary data**

Utilise the analysis and data collection plan from step 2 to gather and appropriately store the identified secondary data, ensuring alignment with the chosen analytical framework. This may involve continuing ongoing data collection efforts from steps 1 and 2, or initiating a focused process to locate, acquire, and store new information. In some cases, secondary data might be the sole source for the assessment.

Outputs

- **Assessment Register updated** ^D | Template [C3.1.2a](#) | Example [C3.1.2b](#) | [Resource](#)

This tool tracks both completed and planned assessments, including who conducted them and their locations. It helps monitor information gaps and minimise duplication. Maintain this as a living document throughout the process.

- **Secondary Data Repository** ^E | Template [C3.1.3a](#) | Example [C3.1.3](#)

Structure this repository around a suitable analytical approach (such as the one outlined in Chapter 1) to efficiently capture available secondary data. Consider using simple tools like whiteboards, sticky notes, or Excel.

- **Develop and test primary data collection tools**

This stage focuses on operationalizing the data collection plan from step 2. The data collection plan will specify the necessary data, the questions to be asked, and the preferred collection methods. This information now needs to be transformed into practical tools for the assessment teams. These tools might take various forms, such as Mobile Data Collection (MDC) surveys on platforms like KoboToolbox or facilitator guides for focus group discussions.

It is crucial to test, revise, and adapt any tools to ensure they effectively address the data collection needs. While you do not need to create new tools for every operation, any existing tools must be thoroughly evaluated and adapted to suit the current context. Avoid simply replicating tools from previous operations without careful consideration. The tools you choose should align with the data collection plan and respect (or adapt to) any existing data collection tools and processes within the country or National Society.

Outputs

- **Data collection tool(s)** ^E | MDC guidance [C3.3.6](#) | XLS guidance [C3.3.15](#) | Primary data collection techniques [C3.3.3](#) | ODK Guidance [C3.3.14](#) | [Survey Designer](#)

These tools will differ for each ENA, depending on the identified needs and context. They should be designed to fulfil the requirements outlined in the data collection plan. Remember the importance of this plan; ensure that any tools — whether created, copied, or adapted — meet its specifications.

- **Assemble and train field assessments teams**

Identify, train, and brief the assessment teams responsible for data collection. These teams play a crucial role and may consist of dedicated staff, volunteers, and potentially inter-agency partners (in coordinated or joint assessments).

Ideally, select a dedicated group of staff and volunteers with experience as enumerators. However, this may not always be feasible. Regardless of team composition, ensure that everyone involved receives training on key enumerator skills, the tools being used, and the purpose of the assessments. This is essential to minimise errors and enhance overall data quality.

Outputs

- **Training Materials and Instructional Packages** ^D | Resources [C3.3.4](#) | Guides [C3.3.5](#)

The scope and scale of training can vary depending on the operational context, ranging from comprehensive multi-day events with structured training packages, to brief, informal sessions introducing the tools, questions, and plan of action. Incorporate minimum standards for Community Engagement and Accountability (CEA) and Protection, Gender, and Inclusion (PGI) into this process.

- **Data Collection Team Members Training Session(s)** ^E

Once training materials are prepared, all enumerators should receive training and understand their role expectations, even if providing informal support. This training should also include an understanding of the minimum standards for CEA and PGI. This crucial step helps reduce data quality issues and adds a layer of accountability. Assessments, like all humanitarian work, must adhere to the "do no harm" principle, especially when working directly with affected populations to collect data.

- **Data Collection Team HR List** ^D | Template [C3.3.1a](#) | Examples [C3.3.1b](#)

After identifying and training enumerators, document their information to track available assessment resources and anticipate future needs. This information might already be integrated into existing National Society or operational HR systems. If not, creating a dedicated list can be valuable for assessment management and planning. It also serves as an accountability measure, ensuring enumerators have received proper training and clearance. This list can be combined with the Field Assessment Visits Tracking Sheet (see below) to track enumerator assignments and experience. This helps with data quality checks, issue log reviews, and tracking enumerator familiarity with the ENA process.

- **Implement and manage field visits**

Once the tools have been developed and tested, and the staff/volunteers have been trained, it is time for data collection. Each team should receive briefings before deployment and debriefings upon return. For larger assessments, tracking field movements and assessment status can help monitor progress and enhance team safety and security. Regardless of scale, it is recommended to track issues and capture lessons learned during implementation.

Outputs

- **Field assessment visits tracking sheet** ^D | Template [C3.3.2a](#) | Example [C3.3.2b](#)

Similar to an operational 3W matrix, this sheet specifically tracks assessment activities. It should track which teams are working in which areas, and on which days, and highlight which areas have been completed and/or not completed. This can be integrated into the workplan from step 2 or used as a standalone document with potentially more operational detail, such as tracking specific staff/volunteers at each location, the vehicle used, the driver, and even the equipment taken.

- **Field assessment team's pre-assessment briefings** ^E | Checklist [C3.3.7](#)

Before deployment, each team (or multiple teams together) should receive a briefing outlining the day's Plan of Action, assessment locations and targets, duration, logistics, and security processes. This is also an opportunity for teams to ask questions and raise any issues, concerns, or blockers observed in the process, allowing for adaptation and learning to maintain data quality.

- **Field assessment teams debriefing** ^E | Checklist [C3.3.8](#)

Utilise this for a quick "hot debrief" to capture immediate learnings from the field collection process, which can then be used to adapt and mitigate issues where possible. A more detailed "cold debrief" can be conducted later to review the entire process. Importantly, this also serves as a physical check on the teams, ensuring their safe return (both physically and mentally) and that equipment is accounted for and undamaged.

- **Issue log** ^D | Template [C3.3.9a](#) | Example [C3.3.9b](#)

Use this to track issues arising during the collection process, captured during briefings or through ad-hoc reporting from the field team. Some issues may be resolvable during data collection (ideally, this should also be logged), while others may inform revisions to the context or assessment plan for future assessments.

- **Collect and record data**

Before field data collection begins, establish a designated database or repository for data entry. The process may vary depending on the specific data collection methods and tools used. There might even be multiple databases to accommodate different tools. Regardless, ensure the incoming data is stored and organised systematically. Planning and setting this up beforehand is crucial for maintaining data quality.

Outputs

- **Primary data database** ^E | Example KII database [C3.3.10](#) | Example Focus group [C3.3.11](#)

The structure of this database will depend on the data collection tool(s) employed. There might be multiple databases if multiple tools are used. The data entry process can also vary; for example, an MDC tool might automatically populate an Excel database during assessments, whereas focus group discussion notes might be recorded on paper and then manually entered into a Word template.

- **Manage and Prepare data**

Once all the data has been collected and stored in the appropriate databases, it needs to be organised, sorted, and prepared for analysis (the next step). The critical task here is data cleaning, ensuring that all data is usable. This stage might uncover data issues previously missed, necessitating validation or re-collection.

Outputs

- **Cleaning procedures and change ^D**

Even with small datasets, outlining the cleaning process is beneficial. It allows someone new or external to the team to understand the data transformations. In essence, if you shared the final cleaned database, this person should be able to reverse these steps to reach the original raw data. This promotes transparency and reduces the risk of misinterpretations during analysis. It also enables multiple people to contribute to data cleaning as long as they adhere to the same procedures.

- **Data and coding reference guide ^D | Example [C3.3.12](#)**

During collection or cleaning, data might be coded. For example, sex might be recorded as 'M' and 'F', or a question about residence might be coded as 'Q1.2.3'. Cleaning might involve shortening long questions, replacing text with numerical values (e.g., 'Yes' becomes '1', 'No' becomes '0'), and more. Document all coding decisions in a reference guide; this benefits everyone involved, especially those conducting the analysis.

- **Cleaned primary data database ^E**

The key output of the acquisition process is all required data, cleaned and organised in a database, ready for analysis. The main difference from the initial database is that it is ready for analysis.

3.4. Step 4: Analyse and draw results [Operational]

Overview

Analysis Range [C3.4.2](#) | Sources of Errors [C3.4.3](#) | Cognitive Biases [C3.4.1](#) | Six Thinking Hats [C3.4.4](#) | Population figures [C3.4.6](#) | Good Enough Analysis Guide [C3.4.5](#)

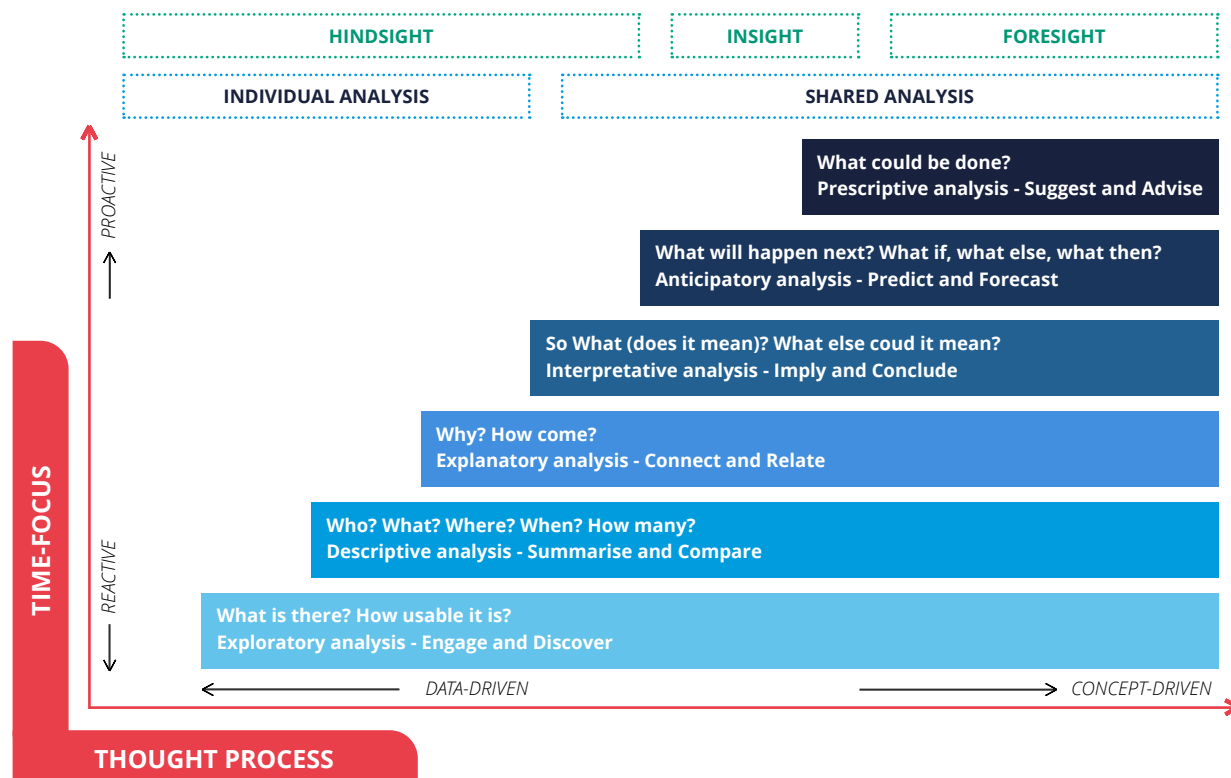
Step 4, analysis, involves transforming raw data into actionable insights. The analysis should provide answers to the key understandings identified in the ENA analytical framework, such as understanding the crisis impacts. This is achieved by utilising the analysis plan developed in step 2 (Design), which outlines the necessary data/information and how it can be used and combined to gain the required insights.

The depth and detail of the analysis process, like other ENA steps, can vary based on operational needs and can be revisited and built upon in later stages.

The Analysis Range

The Analysis Range concept provides a useful structure for the analysis process, progressively building depth and detail. The key activities and outputs listed in Figure 14 reflect this progression, moving from descriptive analysis (the who, what, where) to the more complex and predictive anticipation analysis (what will happen next? what if, what else, what then?).

Figure 15: The Analysis Range: From description to anticipation



Note: Every operation will present different challenges, and every ENA process should be adapted to meet them. The following list of activities should be approached with a level of flexibility and adaptability. What matters is that the quality and usefulness of the ENA is good enough for decision-making. To help identify essential vs desirable outputs, the notation ^E is used for essential and ^D for desirable.

Key activities

• Summarise and compare [Describe]

This is the most common level of analysis conducted in operations. Most reports, such as DREFs, Sit-reps, or country profiles, summarise and compare available data/information. This falls under descriptive analysis, the second level in the analysis spectrum. Describing data means condensing large volumes of information to highlight main points, important stories, and useful messages. It involves grouping, summarising, and comparing data.

- **Grouping** entails collecting similar observations, treating them as a whole, and focusing on data relevant to the analysis.
- **Summarising** involves aggregating observations into concise statements that accurately represent them. Analysts should ensure that important details or variations are not overlooked during summarization.
- **Comparison** lies at the heart of analysis, revealing similarities and differences. Identifying differences or similarities between observations or narratives helps uncover patterns, trends, and anomalies in the data.
- **Patterns**, such as ranks, proportions, trends, distributions, deviations, and correlations, form the foundation of meaningful narratives.

Outputs

◦ **Summary statistics** ^E | Snapshot Guide [C3.4.8](#)

Thi Summary statistics (also known as descriptive statistics) are simple yet powerful tools for analysing quantitative data. They offer a quick way to uncover insights within data by examining their statistical distribution. Summary statistics focus on seven key metrics: (1) Minimum, (2) Maximum, (3) Mean, (4) Median, (5) Upper quartile, (6) Lower quartile, and (7) Interquartile range (IQR). These statistics reveal valuable information about the data, including the most common value (mean or median), the range of the data, its distribution (e.g., age demographics), and the presence of outliers or anomalies. This information provides context and understanding for further analysis and may even generate new questions to explore.

◦ **Key Assumptions** ^E | Template [C3.4.7a](#) | Example [C3.4.7b](#)

Analysts must acknowledge the potential impact of missing data, information gaps, inaccuracies, measurement errors, or suspicious data on the quality of their results. The key assumption checklist aids in documenting assumptions and their potential influence on the final results if they prove inaccurate.

• Connect and Relate [Explain]

Connecting and relating data involves understanding the reasons behind observed events. It entails taking the described information and explaining its causation. This differs from interpreting the data (the subsequent step) and focuses solely on identifying causes.

For example, if the description states that 200 homes have been damaged, the cause might simply be an earthquake. In many cases, the cause may be obvious and require no explicit mention. However, the cause might not always be clear-cut, and multiple explanations might exist.

Outputs

◦ **List of rival hypotheses** ^D

Depending on the assessment's scale and timeframe, exploring all possible causes can be beneficial. This can be a valuable group exercise to examine the factors driving a situation based on the available data. List

potential explanations, along with the assumptions and limitations of each hypothesis. This helps identify the most likely hypothesis while acknowledging alternatives. This exercise can be particularly useful later in response options analysis to justify decisions or assess the level of risk associated with an intervention

• Interpret and conclude [Interpret]

Interpretive analysis aims to move beyond mere findings by drawing and evaluating conclusions (addressing the "so what?" question) through careful debate and evaluation of the evidence and context. Humanitarian analysts must distinguish between what is important and what is simply interesting. This requires understanding and measuring the severity of the crisis and its various issues to prioritise the most critical ones.

This process presents challenges, necessitating agreement on definitions (severity of what), categories (meaning of severity levels), and aggregation methods (weighted or non-weighted). While these don't need to be overly complex, they must be applied consistently and methodically by all involved.

Outputs

- **Severity Ranking** ^D | Detailed Guide [C3.4.9](#)

This allows for the investigation and identification of the most pressing issues that need to be communicated to end-users. The ranking should be further elaborated based on the ENA's scope to be disaggregated by priority groups, sectors, and geographical areas.

- **Current priority needs** ^E | Detailed Guide [C3.4.9](#)

Building on the severity rankings, this moves from stating the extent of the issue to interpreting it as a humanitarian need. It helps identify the most critical needs that need to be conveyed to your audience. Similar to severity rankings, this should be disaggregated based on the ENA's scope, focusing on priority groups and geographical areas.

• Predict and Forecast [Anticipate]

In some cases, it can be valuable to look ahead and project how the situation might unfold, asking questions like "what next?", "what if?", and "what else?". This entails forecasting and predicting potential scenarios, also known as anticipatory analysis or scenario planning. Within the Movement, this often involves scenario planning, examining multiple potential pathways the situation could take. It also proves useful for resource planning.

Outputs

- **Forecast priority needs** ^D

Building upon current priority needs, explore how these needs might evolve as the situation progresses. Needs will change, and understanding these shifts is essential for operational planning. A minor need now may become a top priority in the future, requiring significant scaling up of resources. Anticipating and planning for such changes, or implementing early interventions to mitigate them, can be highly effective.

- **Scenario planning** ^E | Example report [C3.4.12a](#) | Example discussion [C3.4.12b](#) | Snapshot Guide [C3.4.15](#)

Examining how the situation may evolve is a valuable planning tool. Establish a baseline scenario and then present variations based on key potential changes. These scenarios should outline expected impacts, their scale, and the likelihood of each scenario occurring.

- **Response options [Prescribe]**

Finally, it is crucial to ask, "So what can be done about this?" This stage involves considering everything we've learned and analysed and exploring potential actions to assist those in need. A response options analysis systematically determines the best way to address identified needs.

For instance, in a food crisis where access to food is a problem, the analysis involves systematically deciding whether it is more effective to provide food directly or provide cash so people can purchase food locally.

Outputs

- **Operational recommendations** ^E [Modalities Checklist C3.4.14](#) | [Modalities Advantages & Disadvantages C3.4.13](#)

While it might not always be feasible or appropriate for the assessment team to lead the response options analysis, it should at least provide a list of recommendations based on its findings. These recommendations should guide the response, suggesting suitable modalities and key interventions (e.g., shelter reconstruction). Reference the Modalities Checklist and Modalities Advantages & Disadvantages documents for support.

- **Response options Analysis** ^E [Template basic C3.4.17a](#) | [Example C3.4.17b](#) | [Template weighted C3.4.16a](#) | [Example C3.4.16b](#)

This analysis is crucial for any response and must be completed. The ENA process should directly support this effort. An ENA provides insights that inform decision-makers and help them make the right choices regarding operational planning. This step should never be skipped. The analysis can be as quick and basic or as in-depth as the situation demands. It involves listing all potential activities that could address the identified priority needs, considering feasibility, capacity, and suitability within the context, and then selecting the most appropriate option(s).

3.5. Step 5: Share and Evaluate [Operational]

Overview

Ensuring the message is heard is the most crucial step in any ENA. Even the most well-planned and executed ENA is of little value if its findings are not communicated effectively. Effective communication involves adapting the message and delivery method to suit different audiences. The information needs and preferred communication styles of a technical sector lead may differ significantly from those of a Programme Manager or Secretary General. While it is tempting to consider the ENA complete after analysis (step 4), effective communication of the findings is crucial for its overall success. This communication strategy should have been planned for and integrated into the process during step 2 (Design). Nevertheless, it is beneficial to review and adapt the plan as needed and, most importantly, put it into action.

This is also a valuable opportunity to critically evaluate the ENA outputs. Assess what worked well, what did not, and whether the outputs answered the necessary questions. As mentioned previously, ENA is a cyclical process, allowing for revisiting and adapting steps at any point. The lessons learned here can inform and guide these adjustments. They can also shape future assessments within the operation, even those not directly linked to the ENA process. Capturing and sharing these learnings is a valuable and impactful process that extends beyond the primary goal of the ENA, strengthening assessments and ultimately enhancing decision-making.

Note: Every operation will present different challenges, and every ENA process should be adapted to meet them. The following list of activities should be approached with a level of flexibility and adaptability. What matters is that the quality and usefulness of the ENA is good enough for decision-making. To help identify essential vs desirable outputs, the notation ^E is used for essential and ^D for desirable.

Key activities

- **Conceptualize product(s) and Dissemination plan**

Building on the groundwork laid in step 2 (Design) of the workflow, it may be necessary to review and adapt the initial communication plan. The crucial focus here is on understanding how the gathered information will be presented, shared, and disseminated after identifying "what we want to know." Effective communication involves ensuring that the findings reach the right audiences at the right time. It is also important to consider any existing frameworks, timeframes, or restrictions that might dictate how or when the findings are shared.

Outputs

- **Product(s) templates** ^E *Templates - Initial* [C3.2.12](#) | *Rapid* [C3.2.13](#) | *Scenario reporting* [C3.2.14](#)

The end products should effectively bridge the gap between the findings and the audience. Consider the audience's preferred information consumption methods and balance this with the necessary level of detail. Prior planning ensures the audience receives the right information at the right time in a suitable format, streamlining the transition from analysis to sharing. The provided templates serve as a starting point; additional products may be beneficial depending on the situation.

- **Dissemination plan and product pipeline** ^E *Example Dissemination Plan* [C3.2.6](#) | *Example Product Pipeline* [C3.2.7](#)

Understanding the optimal timing for sharing products is beneficial not only for the assessment team's planning but also for the wider operation to anticipate information delivery. A clear and accessible dissemination plan keeps key audiences informed and engaged throughout the assessment process. A product pipeline details all the steps involved in preparing products for dissemination; it is essentially a detailed workplan focused on the products.

• Report and disseminate

Once data collection and analysis are finalised, and the communication strategy is in place, it is time to create and share the results. As noted, the format and sharing method may vary based on the audience and purpose. However, regardless of the format or how the results are shared, it is crucial to include any assumptions and/or limitations in the analysis, clearly conveying the level of confidence in the findings to the end-users so they can interpret and utilise the information appropriately.

Outputs

- **Report template** *Example Report* [C3.5.1](#) | *Example Situational Analysis* [C3.5.2](#) | *Example Dashboard*

The end products can vary based on audience needs and the message conveyed. It is vital to include the level of confidence in the findings, outlining any limitations or assumptions made during analysis. Ensure adequate time for thorough peer review to avoid critical mistakes before publication.

• Data sharing and data Protection

Depending on the final product(s), sharing available ENA data (primary or secondary) internally or externally might be beneficial or necessary. This facilitates validation by other teams and helps minimise duplicate assessments, leading to reduced assessment fatigue among affected populations.

However, it is important to ensure that data sharing is conducted securely and effectively, in compliance with data protection regulations and safeguarding personal information.

Outputs

- **Shared access to data and documentation** ^E *Checklist* [C3.2.4](#) | *Guidance*

Adhering to the data ownership and confidentiality protocols established in step 2, data should be shared internally and externally where possible. This promotes transparency, reduces assessment duplication, and provides valuable insights to the broader humanitarian network, enabling swift and effective action to meet the needs of those affected. Remember, primary data sharing requires consent from those they were collected from.

• Review and improve process, tools, and trainings

While it is important to capture learnings throughout the process and adapt as needed for effective delivery, a comprehensive evaluation might not be feasible until after implementation. At this stage, it can be valuable to review the ENA process, examining each step's effectiveness and identifying areas for improvement. This cannot only enhance future ENA outputs within the current operation, but also strengthen ENA practices at a country or global level. The evaluation can be as light or as in-depth as the context allows, but even a quick evaluation can add substantial value to future ENA efforts.

Outputs

- **Lessons learned report and advice** ^D *Issue log Template* [C3.5.3a](#) | *Report Template* [C3.5.4](#)

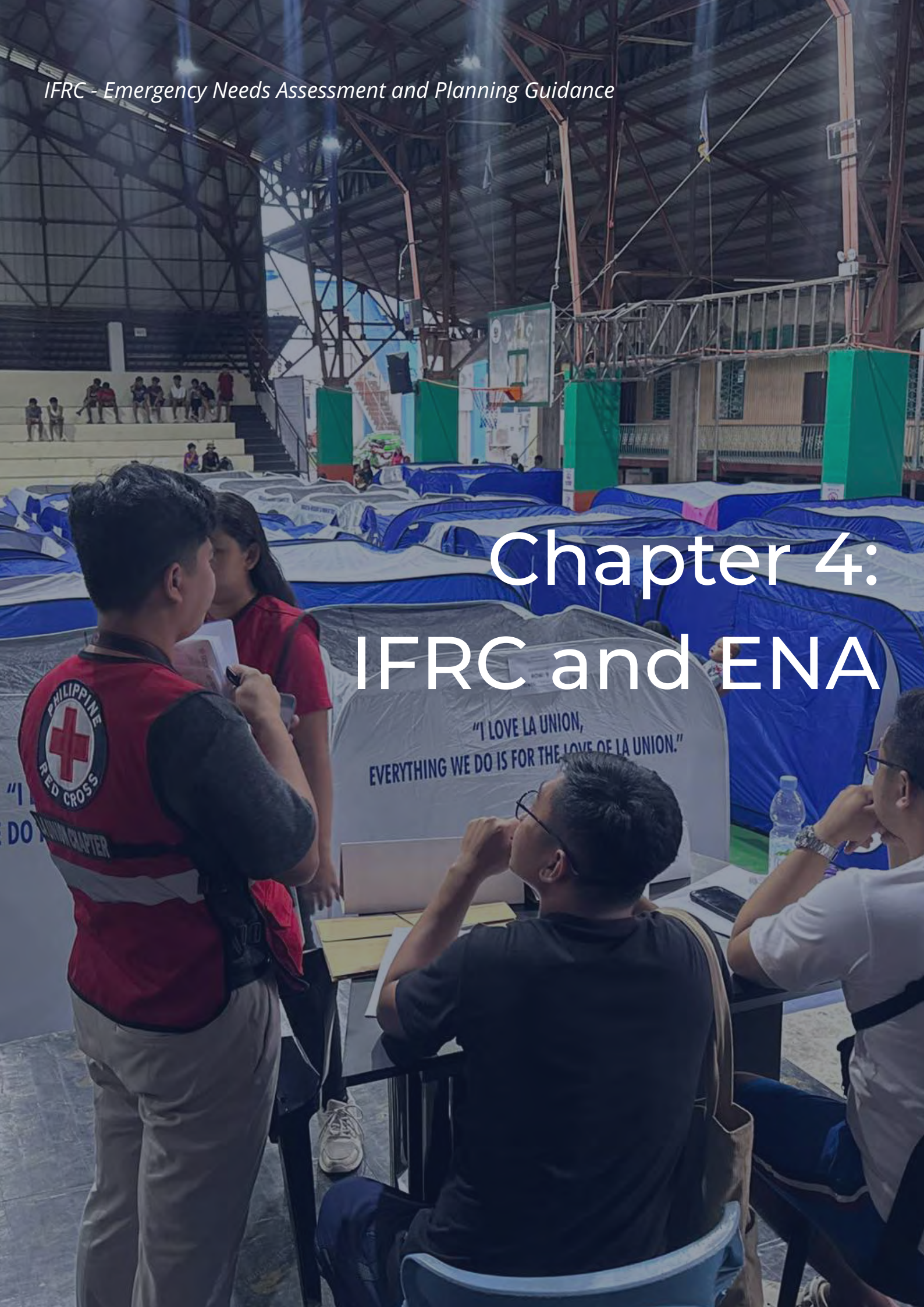
This report, formal or informal and as in-depth or light-touch as needed, should examine each stage of the ENA process so far, highlighting what worked well and what did not, and how this impacted the final products. Offer practical advice on minimising shortcomings and reinforcing strengths, while also acknowledging successes. Utilise an issue log to track challenges and actions during the ENA process, enhancing the reporting process.

Chapter 3 - Conclusion

By diligently navigating the five stages of the ENA workflow —Contextualize, Design, Collect, Analyse, and Share—, we can ensure that our assessments are well-planned, efficiently executed, and effectively communicated. This systematic approach enables us to gain a comprehensive understanding of the crisis, identify priority needs, and inform impactful response strategies. Remember, ENA is an iterative process; each step builds upon the previous ones, and the insights gained throughout the workflow can be used to refine and enhance future assessments.

By embracing this adaptive and collaborative approach, we can strengthen our ability to respond effectively to disasters and crises, ultimately contributing to a more resilient and empowered global community.

Chapter 4: IFRC and ENA



Chapter 4: IFRC and ENA

The reader understands ENA in IFRC operations, when to use it, and what resources are available to deliver it (Assessment Cell).

This chapter explores the essential elements needed to implement ENAs effectively, ranging from individual knowledge and skills to team composition and necessary equipment. The primary focus is on IFRC operations, but the guidance can be adapted to other contexts. An ENA should be flexible and adaptable, and the information presented in it is not set in stone. It is crucial to tailor these recommendations to the specific context and needs of the situation at hand. The most important factor is having the right people, teams, and resources to successfully accomplish the task.

4.1. ENA in IFRC operations

This ENA guidance serves as the primary reference for conducting ENAs following sudden-onset emergencies classified as orange or red. It outlines the approach to follow throughout each operation, including recommended purpose, key expected outputs, sampling and data collection methodologies, and links to other relevant disaster response tools. While ENA encompasses five key assessment approaches, the primary focus for IFRC operations is on initial, rapid, and in-depth assessments (see Table 3).

Table 3: ENA in IFRC operations

Purpose/Objectives	Risk Assessment	Initial Assessment	Rapid Assessment	In-Depth Assessment	Needs Monitoring
Sampling Strategies		Non-representative	Purposive	Representative	
Data Types*	Secondary Data	Primary & secondary data	Primary & secondary data	Primary & secondary data	Primary & secondary data
IFRC Disaster Response Tools	Preparedness for Effective Response / Contingency & Response Plan / Vulnerability Capacity Assessments	BRTs/NRTs/RRTs Regional Office Support RR/Assessment Team	BDRTs/NDRTs/RDRTs Regional Office Support RR/Assessment Team/ERUs	BDRTs/NDRTs/RDRTs Regional Office Support RR/Assessment Team/ERUs	National Society Long Term Operation Team Recovery Assessment Team
Data Collection Methods	Pre-Disaster Monitoring through network of Volunteers	Direct Observation Key Informants	Key informant Direct Observation Community Group Discussion	Key informant Direct Observation Focus Group / HH Discussion	Post-Disaster Management through network of Volunteers
Preparedness	Pre-disaster	Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Following months
IFRC Global Outputs	Secondary Data Analysis	Emergency Appeal DREF Loan	IFRC Global Outputs	IFRC Global Outputs	Ad hoc Monitoring Updates
Timeframe (indicative, overlapping and contextual)		48 hours Maximum for IFRC - ENA Phase 1	14 days Maximum for IFRC - ENA Phase 2	40 days Maximum for IFRC - ENA Phase 3	

*Secondary data collection should consider NS, IFRC and ICRC institutional knowledge; and external data sources as for inter-agency network, Post Disaster or Conflict Needs Assessments (PDNA or PCNA), market assessments, census data or Households Economy Approach (HEA) data.

In orange and red scale emergencies, the National Society should undertake assessment design and planning with support from an assessment specialist (Assessment Cell). The same deployment can be requested by the National Society for smaller-scale disasters (white or yellow emergencies). It is important to note that this process and framework are conceptual and should always be adapted to the specific context, as disasters and crises can be non-linear. This is especially true for small-scale disasters, slow-onset and protracted crises, or sudden-onset emergencies within complex environments. In such cases, the timeframe, purpose, expected outputs, resources, coordination framework with local authorities and other actors, and disaster response tools may need to be adjusted.

This approach recognizes the potential impact of the Surge Assessment Cell on the National Society's decision-making processes. Surge assessment specialists should prioritise supporting National Society and Movement partners in their ENA efforts, building upon their prior experiences, knowledge, and pre- and post-disaster capacities.

When requested, the Assessment Cell (AC) will be funded through DREF and Emergency Appeal. In support of the National Society, they would be embedded within the Surge deployment in-country setup, reporting to the current IFRC Surge Head of Operation (i.e., Operation Manager or HEOps) and liaising with relevant sectoral and cross-cutting leads (i.e., NS, RRT) for specific inputs.

What does the Assessment Cell bring to an Operation?

- The Assessment Cell team members will support National Society and Movement partners in conducting ENAs to identify key priority needs and evidence for informing emergency planning processes and documents.
- It will be deployed in-country or remotely, possessing a broad range of competencies (strategic thinking, coordination, information analysis, data management, etc.) and diverse composition to adapt to the specificities of disaster and crisis response.
- The team will assist National Society and Movement partners in engaging and liaising with inter-agency processes, such as the IASC assessment cell or joint assessments, if relevant and not hindering the RCRC response. It will also support the identification and use of relevant assessment findings from other stakeholders to enhance the quality of IFRC ENAs.
- This team will be responsible for ensuring that, in support of the National Society, the IFRC, PNSs, and other Movement partners contribute to the same process, avoiding duplication and utilising common operational datasets (CODs) and key assessment indicators. The team will also support National Society and IFRC Surge leadership in enhancing the integration of assessments within current priorities, optimising the use of available resources, and ensuring that assessment findings effectively feed into Movement coordination mechanisms (e.g., Task Forces), communications, planning processes, and documents.

4.2. IFRC Assessment Cell procedures

The Assessment Cell can be deployed in-country or remotely, equipped with a diverse skill set encompassing assessment, coordination, information gathering, management and analysis, GIS, and other relevant expertise. The team's composition is tailored to the specific context, considering factors such as existing capacities, deployed stakeholders, the emergency phase, and the scope and scale of the disaster or crisis.

In large-scale emergencies, the Assessment Cell reports to the operation's multi-sectoral coordinator (e.g., Ops Manager, Program Manager) and supports sectoral coordinators in ensuring their Operational Strategy is evidence-based. Currently, personnel trained in Emergency Needs Assessment and Planning, Humanitarian Information Analysis, Survey Design, and Mobile Data Collection are available. Designed for orange and red scale emergencies, the Assessment Cell bolsters response efforts through the deployment of specialised assessment teams.

The Assessment Cell can adjust its configuration and the competencies of deployed role profiles based on the emergency phase, existing capacities, and the scope and scale of the disaster or crisis.

The AC's Key priorities: - [Assessment Cell](#)

- Establish or Support Assessment Strategy Development: Collaborate with the National Society to either create a new assessment strategy or enhance an existing one.
- Develop Data Collection and Analysis Plans: Work with the National Society to design comprehensive plans for data collection and analysis.
- Secondary Data Analysis: Utilise for secondary data review and analysis.
- Implement ENAs: Conduct or assist in the implementation of various ENAs, including initial, rapid, and in-depth assessments.
- Provide Insights and Analysis: Offer in-depth analysis on the crisis profile, impacts, severity of conditions, and gaps in the response.
- Data Collection Support: Provide templates, forms, and guidance on data collection processes.
- Volunteer Training: Train volunteers to serve as data collectors within the field assessment team.
- Coordinate with Multi-Sectoral Coordination Mechanisms: Engage and collaborate with relevant national and cluster-level coordination bodies.
- Scenario Building: Assist sectors in developing scenario plans.
- Lessons Learned: Generate a lessons learned report with recommendations for future deployments.

Assessment Cell Surge Profiles - [Catalogue of Surge Services ENA](#)

IFRC has a comprehensive list of profiles to support NS respond to disasters, these profiles can be found on the [catalogue of services](#). There are four key role-profiles for the Surge Assessment Cell teams:

- **Assessment Coordinator** - [Surge profile](#)

These individual leads assessment support to the National Society and Movement partners in conducting Emergency Needs Assessments (ENAs) and other humanitarian needs analyses. In large-scale emergencies, the Assessment Coordinator heads the deployed assessment team, ensuring timely, accurate, and relevant multi-sectoral needs assessment results inform operational decision-making. They play a crucial role in coordinating all IFRC sectoral assessments and collaborates with both National Society partners and external stakeholders to prevent duplication and foster synergies. The Assessment Coordinator may be deployed at different stages of the operation. If deployed outside of the first surge rotation, the focus might shift towards in-depth multi-sector assessments for recovery.

- **Humanitarian Information Analysis Officer** - [Surge profile](#)

This role focuses on implementing all analytical processes and outputs during an operation, working closely with the National Society. S/he ensures the implementation of analytical frameworks and analysis plans throughout the operation and across IFRC sectors. The officer is responsible for using innovative approaches and solutions for qualitative and quantitative analysis, including software. S/he advises the operation on identifying priority sectors, geographic locations, and needs severity based on evidence-based data analytics. This officer's findings are communicated through standard analytical outputs delivered in a timely manner to support operational decision-making.

- **Primary Data Collection Officer** - [Surge profile](#)

This officer leads the implementation of primary data collection solutions during an operation, again in close collaboration with the National Society. Ensures standardised tool and survey implementation across the operation and within IFRC sectors. The officer is also responsible for implementing best practices for primary data collection and maintaining coordination with the IFRC Mobile Data Collection

Working Group and the SIMS network. Collaborates with IFRC sectors, PMER, the Assessment Cell, and Information Management to produce high-quality surveys for deployment. These surveys are developed in alignment with the agreed-upon analytical framework for the operation. Additionally, the officer supports capacity building in primary data collection for IFRC sectors and the National Society.

- **Mapping and Visualisation Officer** - [Surge profile](#)

This officer is responsible for creating information products for the operation, including maps, spatial analyses, infographics, and web-based dashboards. Ensures standardisation of tools across the operation and within IFRC sectors, aligning products with the IFRC style guide. The officer implements GIS and data visualisation best practices, ensuring product quality meets standards. Works closely with the SIMS network and coordinates with IFRC sectors, PMER, the Assessment Cell, and Information Management to deliver high-quality information products. Finally, the officer supports capacity development in GIS and data visualisation principles for IFRC sectors and the National Society.

Assessment Technical Competency Framework

All Surge staff deployed for ENA will utilise the Assessment Technical Competency Framework. This framework aligns with the [IFRC Core Competency Framework for Surge Personnel](#). It draws upon expertise from the Movement and specialised assessment agencies, offering a shared and systematic approach to recruiting, training, and appraising Surge staff in the field. The framework also fosters a common understanding of the assessment portfolio.

Data collection team

Beyond the core IFRC Surge team outlined above, the data collection team is crucial to any ENA effort. In most cases, this team will comprise National Society members supported by the Assessment Cell. The following outlines the types of roles that may be required to support ENA activities. While the National Society is not obligated to have these specific profiles available, it is important to recognize the resource needs beyond the Surge team for successful ENA implementation. The Surge team can provide support, training, and advice to build, develop, or enhance this team as needed upon arrival.

- **Data Collectors** (*National Society staff / volunteer*)

In most ENA deployments, there will be a need to collect secondary and primary data. This requires individuals to conduct data collection, implementing planned data collection techniques in the required locations. They will utilise assessment tools, collect data, and submit it for analysis. The number of individuals needed for this role will depend on the response's scope and scale, as well as the operational context. It is crucial to ensure team diversity reflects the local culture and context, balancing factors such as gender, ethnicity, religion, and age.

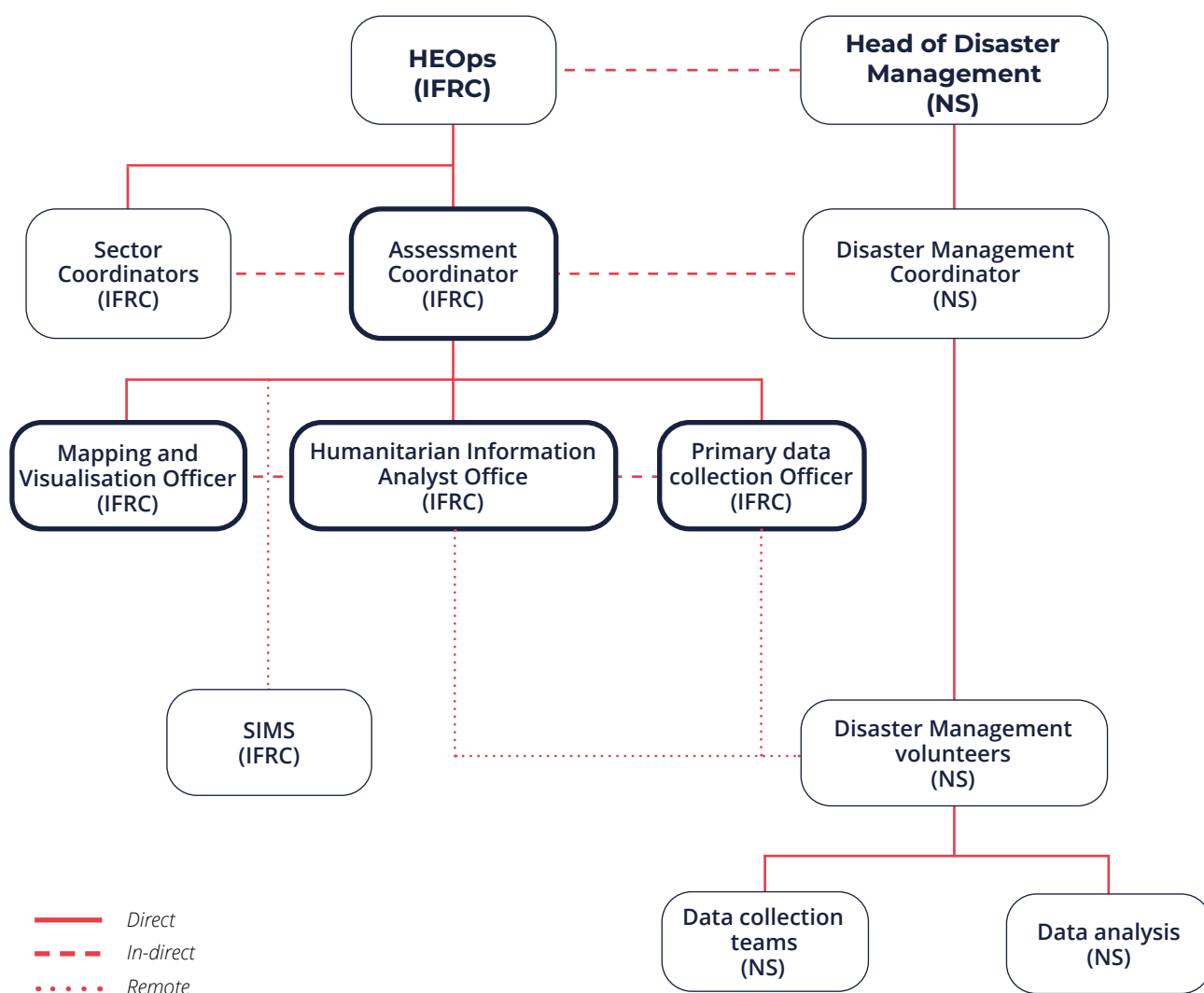
- **Data Analysts** (*National Society staff / volunteer*)

In larger operations with a broad geographic scope, there might be too much data to process centrally. This necessitates resources to support data collation, cleaning, and analysis. These individuals would assist the data collectors, ensuring collected data is accurately collated, stored, and cleaned before analysis. If appropriate, they would also contribute to analysing the collected data.

Example team structures

The example structure below illustrates a potential configuration for the Assessment Cell in large-scale orange or red emergencies. However, it should not be considered the only viable option. The structure should be adapted to the specific context and requirements of the situation.

Figure 16: Example Team Structure for Assessment Cell



Outside IFRC operations

Even in the absence of direct IFRC support, National Societies will still encounter situations requiring ENAs. The outlined structure can be adapted and adopted by National Societies to suit their specific needs. This structure, based on decades of response learning both within and outside the Movement, provides an effective platform for implementing the assessment workflow detailed in this guidance and ultimately enables impactful ENAs that contribute to stronger response planning.

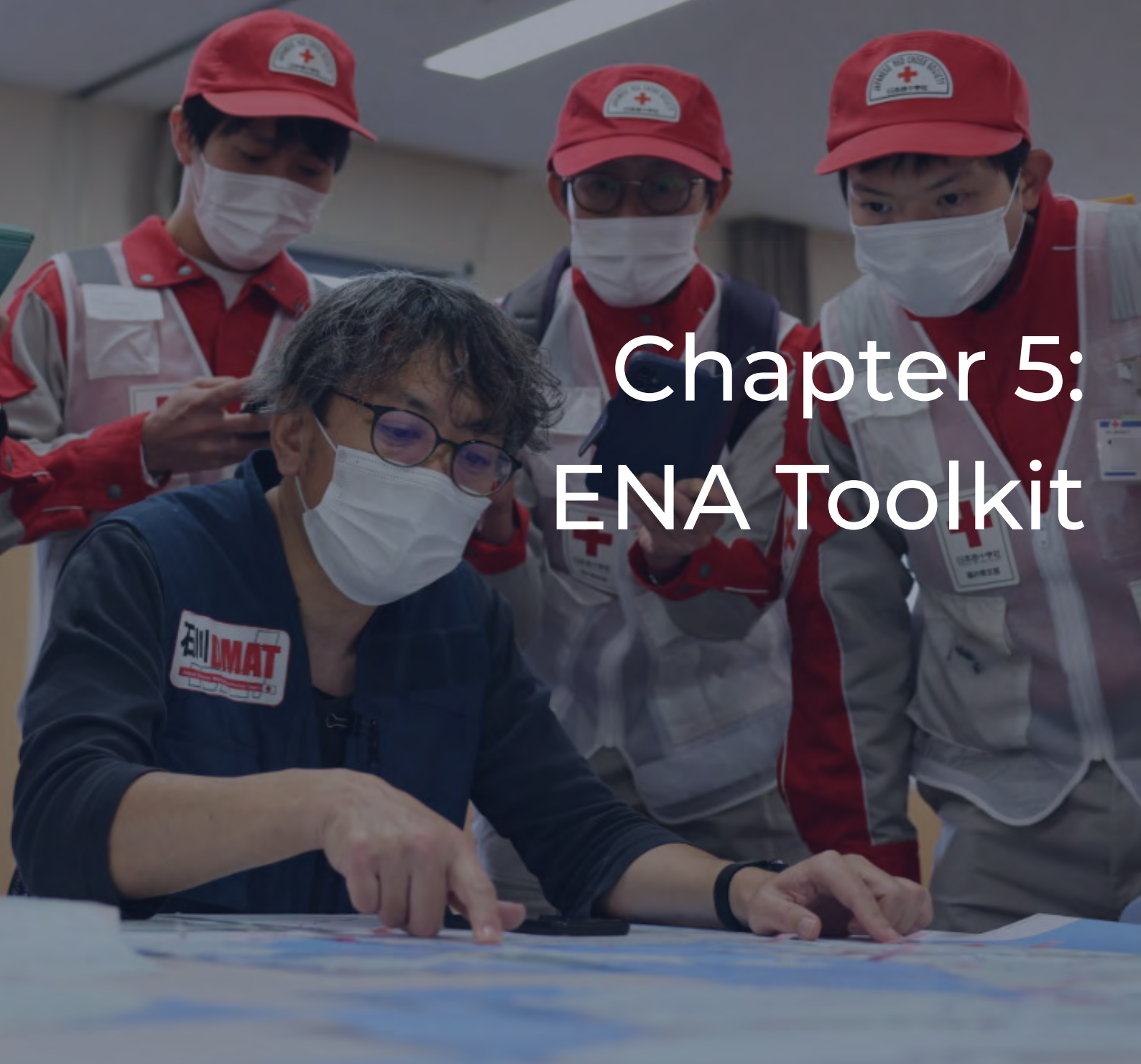
Chapter 4 - Conclusion

This chapter has outlined the various human resources, teams, and support structures necessary for effective ENA implementation, particularly within the context of IFRC operations. It highlighted the importance of assembling competent and diverse assessment teams, ensuring adequate training, and fostering collaboration between internal and external stakeholders.

The outlined Assessment Cell structure and Surge profiles serve as a guide for mobilising expertise and resources in large-scale emergencies. However, the importance of adapting these structures to the specific needs and context of each operation was emphasised. ENA is not a rigid framework but a flexible and adaptable process.

Ultimately, the success of an ENA hinges on the dedication and collaboration of individuals and teams working together to collect, analyse, and share vital information that empowers informed decision-making and impactful humanitarian response. By understanding the roles, responsibilities, and resources required, and by tailoring our approach to each unique situation, we can ensure that ENA remains a powerful tool in our efforts to alleviate suffering and build resilience in the face of disasters and crises.

Chapter 5: ENA Toolkit



Chapter 5: ENA Toolkit

The reader is able to find the tools needed to carry out an ENA

5.1. Your Essential Resource for Effective Assessments

This chapter serves as your comprehensive toolkit for navigating the complexities of the ENA process. It provides a collection of practical resources, including templates, mini-guides, illustrative examples, and useful tools, designed to support each step of the assessment workflow outlined in Chapter 3.

Whether you're a seasoned humanitarian practitioner or new to the field, this toolkit offers valuable guidance and support for:

- **Developing a comprehensive assessment strategy:** Templates and examples to help you define clear objectives, scope, and coordination mechanisms.
- **Designing effective data collection plans:** Mini-guides and checklists to ensure you gather the right information from the right sources using the most appropriate methods.
- **Collecting and managing data efficiently:** Templates and protocols to streamline data collection, storage, and analysis.
- **Analysing and interpreting findings:** Tools and examples to guide you through data analysis and the development of meaningful insights.
- **Communicating and sharing results:** Templates and strategies for effective communication and dissemination of assessment findings to various stakeholders.

By utilising the resources in this toolkit, you will be equipped to conduct ENAs that are:

- **Relevant and timely:** Addressing the specific needs and context of the crisis.
- **Accurate and reliable:** Based on sound data collection and analysis methods.
- **Participatory and inclusive:** Engaging affected populations and key stakeholders throughout the process.
- **Actionable and impactful:** Informing decision-making and driving effective humanitarian response.

Refer to this toolkit alongside the guidance provided in the previous chapters to ensure a comprehensive and successful ENA process.

Index

Tools, Templates, Guides, and Examples

Throughout this guidance document, particularly in Chapter 3 on the "assessment workflow," you will encounter references to various tools, templates, guides, and examples. These resources are identified by a unique index code, such as "C3_1_7b."

Utilising the index codes, you can easily locate the associated resources within the downloadable "5_ENA_Toolbox" that complements this guidance. Each resource file is named using its corresponding index code for straightforward identification (e.g., "C3_2_10a_TEMPLATE_Budget_en_v01"). To further streamline your search, files are organised into folders based on their shared "parent" index code. In the previous example, the relevant folder would be "C3_2_Design."

While the guide also includes direct links to the specific files on the [IFRC Public SharePoint folder](#) or on the [Operational Toolbox](#) on IFRC GO platform, we acknowledge that these links may not always be accessible. In such cases, the index system serves as an alternative method for locating the referenced resources.

The following table lists all resources and index codes available in this guidance package:

Parent folder	Index Code	File Name
C3_1_Contextualize	C3_1_11	C3_1_11_CHECKLIST_understand_context_en_v02
	C3_1_1a	C3_1_1a_TEMPLATE_SDR_Snapshot_en_v01
	C3_1_1b	C3_1_1b_EXAMPLE_BHS_Hurricane_Dorian_Situation_Analysis_1
	C3_1_2a	C3_1_2_TEMPLATE_Assessment_Registry
	C3_1_2b	C3_1_14_EXAMPLE_Assessment_Registry_Mozambique
	C3_1_3a	C3_1_3a_TEMPLATE_SD_repository_en_v01
	C3_1_3b	C3_1_3b_EXAMPLE_SD_repository_en_v01
	C3_1_4a	C3_1_4a_TEMPLATE_SWOT_en_v01
	C3_1_4b	C3_1_4b_EXAMPLE_SWOT_en_v01
	C3_1_6a	C3_1_6a_TEMPLATE_Resource_list_en_v01
	C3_1_6b	C3_1_6b_EXAMPLE_Resource_list_en_v01
	C3_1_7a	C3_1_7a_TEMPLATE_Assessment_strategy_en_v01
	C3_1_7b	C3_1_7b_EXAMPLE_Assessment_strategy_en_v01
	C3_1_8a	C3_1_8a_TEMPLATE_coordination_strategy_en_v01
	C3_1_8b	C3_1_8b_EXAMPLE_coordination_strategy_en_v01
	C3_1_9	C3_1_9_TOOL_Analysis_canvas_en_v01
C3_2_Design	C3_2_10a	C3_2_10a_TEMPLATE_Budget_en_v01
	C3_2_10b	C3_2_10b_EXAMPLE_Budget_en_v01
	C3_2_11a	C3_2_11a_CHECKLIST_24_Hour_Assessment_Checklist_en_V01
	C3_2_11b	C3_2_11b_CHECKLIST_72_Hour_Assessment_Checklist_en_V01
	C3_2_12	C3_2_12_TEMPLATE_Initial_Rapid_Assessment_Report_en_V01
	C3_2_13	C3_2_13_TEMPLATE_rapid_assessment_report_en_V01
	C3_2_14	C3_2_14_TEMPLATE_Scenario_reporting_template_en_V01
	C3_2_15	C3_2_15_Rapid_Assessment_Toolkit
	C3_2_1a	C3_2_1a_TEMPLATE_Assessment_PoA_en_v01
	C3_2_1b	C3_2_1b_EXAMPLE_Assessment_PoA_en_v01
	C3_2_2	C3_2_2_CHECKLIST_ENA_Objectives_Measures_en_V01

Parent folder	Index Code	File Name
C3_2_Design	C3_2_3a	C3_2_3a_TEMPLATE_Analysis_data_collect_plan_en_v01
	C3_2_3b	C3_2_3b_EXAMPLE_Analysis_data_collect_plan_en_v01
	C3_2_4	C3_2_4_CHECKLIST_data_protection_protocol_en_V01
	C3_2_5	C3_2_5_CHECKLIST_assessment_coordination_en_V01
	C3_2_6	C3_2_6_EXAMPLE_product_dissimulation_plan_en_v01
	C3_2_7	C3_2_7_EXAMPLE_product_pipeline_en_v01
	C3_2_9a	C3_2_9a_TEMPLATE_Workplan_en_v01
	C3_2_9b	C3_2_9b_EXAMPLE_Workplan_en_v01
C3_3_Collect	C3_3_10	C3_3_10_EXAMPLE_KII_Database_en_V01
	C3_3_11	C3_3_11_EXAMPLE_FGD_database_en_V01
	C3_3_12	C3_3_12_Data_and_coding_reference_guide_en_V01
	C3_3_13	C3_3_13_EXAMPLE_Secondary_Data_review_report_Yolanda_Philippines
	C3_3_14	C3_3_14_Reference_Manual_-_Open_Data_Kit_and_Mega_V
	C3_3_15	C3_3_15_XLSFORM_tutorial
	C3_3_1a	C3_3_1a_TEMPLATE_Enumerator_list_en_v01
	C3_3_1b	C3_3_1b_EXAMPLE_Enumerator_list_en_v01
	C3_3_2a	C3_3_2a_TEMPLATE_Field_assessment_visits_tracking_en_v01
	C3_3_2b	C3_3_2b_EXAMPLE_Field_assessment_visits_tracking_en_v01
	C3_3_3	C3_3_3_GUIDE_data_collection_techniques_en_v01
	C3_3_4	C3_3_4_survey_design_materials_en_v01
	C3_3_5	C3_3_5_participatory_data_collection_methods
	C3_3_5_1	C3_3_5_1_GUIDE_Transsect_walk_en_v01.pdf
	C3_3_5_2	C3_3_5_2_GUIDE_Focus_group_discussion_en_v01.pdf
	C3_3_5_3	C3_3_5_3_GUIDE_semi_structured_interview_en_v01.pdf
	C3_3_5_4	C3_3_5_4_GUIDE_Direct_observation_en_v01.pdf
	C3_3_5_5	C3_3_5_5_GUIDE_Problem_trees_en_v01.pdf
	C3_3_6	C3_3_6_KoBo_Guidance_en_V01
	C3_3_7	C3_3_7_Briefing_checklist_en_v01
	C3_3_8	C3_3_8_debriefing_checklist_en_v01
	C3_3_9a	C3_3_9a_TEMPLATE_issue_log_en_v01
	C3_3_9b	C3_3_9b_EXAMPLE_issue_log_en_v01
C3_4_Analyse	C3_4_1	C3_4_1_GUIDE_acaps_cognitive_biases
	C3_4_12a	C3_4_12a_EXAMPLE_scenario
	C3_4_12b	C3_4_12b_EXAMPLE_scenario_informal
	C3_4_13	C3_4_13_CHECKLIST_Advantages_Disadvantages_response_modalities
	C3_4_14	C3_4_14_CHECKLIST_key_modality_questions
	C3_4_15	C3_4_15_GUIDE_scenario_development_en_V01
	C3_4_16a	C3_4_16a_TEMPLATE_Response_Options_Matrix_Weighted_en_v01
	C3_4_16b	C3_4_16b_EXAMPLE_Response_Options_Matrix_Weighted_en_v01
	C3_4_16c	C3_4_16c_EXAMPLE_Response_Options_Matrix_Malawi_2019_en_v01

Parent folder	Index Code	File Name
C3_4_Analyse	C3_4_17a	<i>C3_4_17a_TEMPLATE_Response Options Matrix Basic_2n_v01</i>
	C3_4_17b	<i>C3_4_17b_EXAMPLE_Response Options Matrix Basic_2n_v01</i>
	C3_4_2	<i>C3_4_2_GUIDE_Analysis Spectrum</i>
	C3_4_3	<i>C3_4_3_GUIDE_acaps_sources_of_errors</i>
	C3_4_4	<i>C3_4_4_GUIDE_Six_Thinking</i>
	C3_4_5	<i>C3_4_5_GUIDE_Good Analysis</i>
	C3_4_6	<i>C3_4_6_GUIDE_Humanitarian population figures</i>
	C3_4_7a	<i>C3_4_7a_TEMPLATE_Key assumption checklist</i>
	C3_4_7b	<i>C3_4_7b_EXAMPLE_Key assumption checklist</i>
	C3_4_8	<i>C3_4_8_GUIDE_summary_statistics</i>
	C3_4_9	<i>C3_4_9_GUIDE_technical_note_severity_measures</i>
C3_5_Share	C3_5_1	<i>C3_5_1_EXAMPLE_DRC_Nyirangongo_Assesment_EN_V4</i>
	C3_5_2	<i>C3_5_2_EXAMPLE_Yemen, Situation Analysis 28 July 2020_en_V01</i>
	C3_5_3a	<i>C3_5_3a_TEMPLATE_lessons_log_en_v01</i>
	C3_5_3b	<i>C3_5_3b_EXAMPLE_lessons_log_en_v01</i>
	C3_5_4	<i>C3_5_4_TEMPLATE_Lessons learnt report_en_v01</i>
G1_General	G1_2	<i>Assessment workflow</i>
	G1_3	ENA diagram
	G1_5	<i>G1_5_Guidance Note Environmental Sustainability_en_v01</i>

Closing Remarks

This guidance has provided a comprehensive overview of the Emergency Needs Assessment process, equipping humanitarian practitioners with the knowledge and tools needed to conduct effective assessments in diverse crisis contexts. By emphasising a flexible, adaptable, and participatory approach, we aim to empower individuals and teams to navigate the complexities of humanitarian emergencies, ensuring that the needs of affected populations are understood and addressed in a timely and impactful manner.

The structured ENA workflow, coupled with the practical tools and resources provided in this guide, offers a roadmap for conducting assessments that are not only rigorous and evidence-based but also ethically sound and culturally sensitive.

As the humanitarian landscape continues to evolve, so too must our approaches to needs assessment. By embracing a spirit of continuous learning and improvement, and by actively incorporating the insights and experiences of those on the front lines, we can strengthen our collective capacity to respond effectively to disasters and crises, ultimately building a more resilient and equitable world for all.



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